

TELARIS

Editor Manual

For people authoring galaxies, wormholes, and connections inside a Telaris instance.

A FIELD GUIDE TO A NON-HIERARCHICAL ARCHIVE.

V0.1

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Introduction

This manual is for **editors**: the people who shape what a Telaris instance holds. If you author galaxies, place wormholes, link keywords, or curate the relationships between pieces of content, this manual is the day-to-day reference for how the editor surfaces work.

What Telaris is, in one paragraph

Telaris is a three-dimensional, non-hierarchical archive. Content lives in **galaxies**: clusters of **wormholes**, which are the smallest units of content (a passage, an image, a video, a thought). Wormholes connect to each other through shared **keywords**, and the keywords themselves connect to each other through the **keyword canvas**. There are no folders, no parents, no breadcrumbs; the rhizome is the structure. Editors do not build a tree; they tend a thicket.

Who this manual is for

You are an editor if you have been given login credentials and asked to add or organize content. You will need three things to get started: the address of your Telaris instance (a web link, like `https://your-instance.example`), your editor email, and your password. Nothing else; this manual is self-contained from there.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

If a page will not load, a button does nothing, or a message appears that you do not understand, this is the moment to reach out to the person who runs your instance (your **operator**). They keep the lights on. This manual focuses on what you can do once everything is working as expected.

IF YOU ONLY NEED THE BASICS, START WITH THE QUICK START

This document is the **complete** Editor Manual, written for editors who want to learn the surface in depth. If you just need to add a few wormholes right now and learn the rest as you go, a shorter **Editor Quick Start** covers the smallest possible path in five numbered steps, four pages, one read. It is available at:

<https://www.telaris.ca/docs/editor-quick-start.pdf>

After the Quick Start, come back to this document whenever you want the depth.

How this manual is organized

The chapters move from the smallest gesture to the largest. Each chapter opens with what the surface does, then walks through it step by step with screenshots, and closes with a short list of things worth knowing (small surprises, useful shortcuts, current limitations).

1. **Getting in.** Logging in and finding your way around.
2. **Concepts.** Galaxy, wormhole, keyword, portal, canvas, tour. One short page per concept.
3. **Galaxies.** Creating a galaxy, naming it, writing the editorial framing that opens it.
4. **Wormholes.** Authoring the small units of content: text, images, audio, video, PDFs.
5. **Adding media.** Uploading and arranging images, audio files, videos, and PDFs.
6. **Keywords.** Assigning and shaping the keyword layer that connects wormholes.
7. **The keyword canvas.** The relational drawing surface for keyword-to-keyword connections.
8. **Portals.** Building doorways between galaxies.
9. **Visitor views.** What a visitor sees, and how your editor choices shape it.
10. **Tours.** Creating curated paths through a galaxy.
11. **Multigalaxy work.** When an idea lives across more than one galaxy.
12. **Editorial sovereignty.** When *not* to apply a keyword, when to refuse a connection, when to step back.
13. **Troubleshooting.** Common situations and what to do about them.
14. **Glossary.** Every named concept, in one place, defined briefly.

Conventions

- **Menu paths** appear like this: `Galaxies → New galaxy`.
- **Buttons and form fields** appear in bold: **Save**, **Title**, **Visible to visitors**.
- **Keyboard shortcuts** use `Cmd` + `S` (or `Ctrl` + `S` on Windows or Linux).
- **Names of fields, buttons, and menu items** match exactly what you see on screen.
- *Italics* introduce a term the first time it appears.

IF YOU FIND A MISTAKE

This manual is maintained alongside the editor surface itself. If a screenshot is wrong, a label has changed, or a step is missing, tell your operator; the correction lands in the next build.

Getting in

Telaris is a website. To use the editor, you open your instance in a web browser, sign in, and start working. That is the whole login flow; the rest of this chapter walks through what you see, in order.

What you need

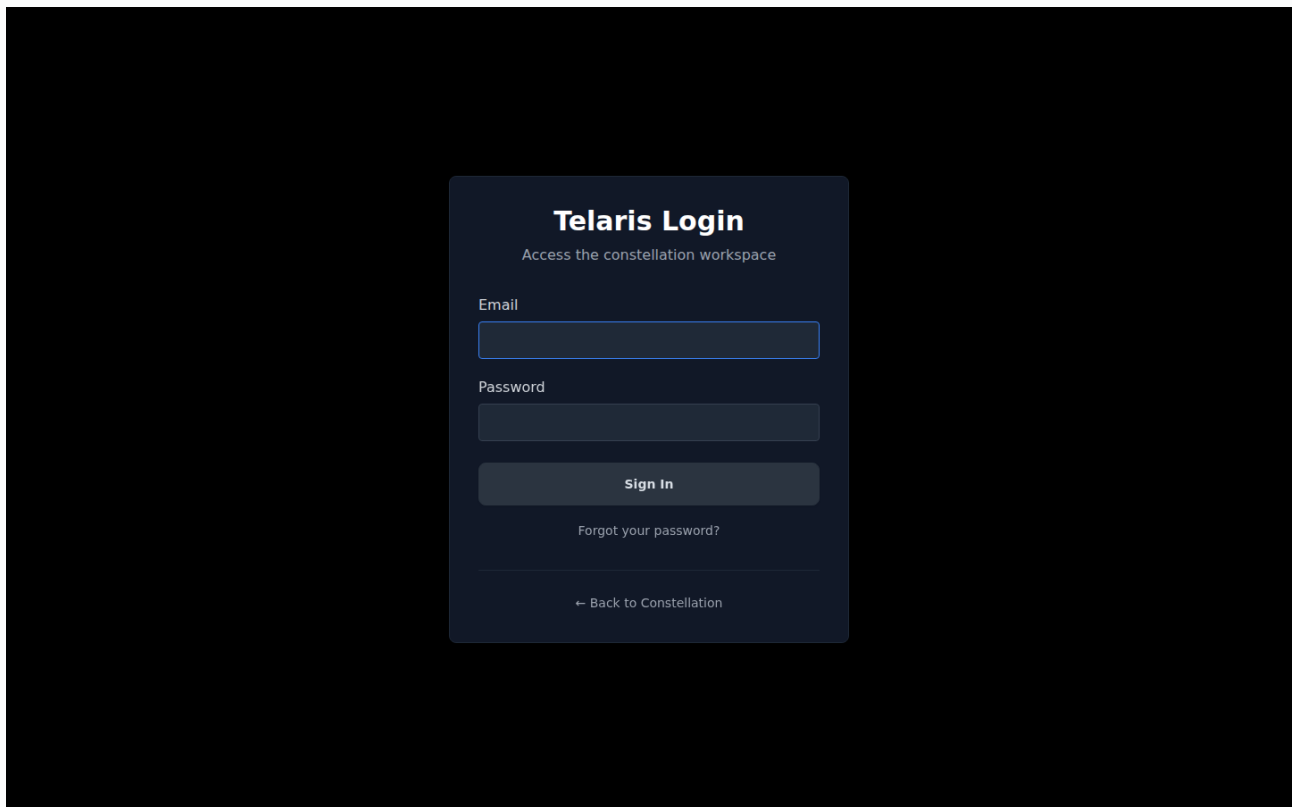
Three things, all supplied by your operator:

- **The address of your Telaris instance:** a web link, something like `https://your-instance.example`. Bookmark it.
- **Your editor email:** the address your operator created the account under.
- **Your password:** chosen by you or sent to you by your operator. If your operator created your account, expect to be asked to set a new password the first time you log in.

If you do not have any of these, ask the person who runs your instance.

The login page

Open your instance's address in any modern browser. If you are not already signed in, you land on the login page automatically. If you have already saved a bookmark to a different part of the instance, the browser will detour you to the login page first and then return to where you were going.



Two fields: **Email** and **Password**. Type your credentials and select **Sign In**.

If you forget your password, there is a **Forgot your password?** link below the Sign In button. The link asks for your email; an email with a reset link lands in your inbox within a minute. Reset links expire after a short window; if the link no longer works, request a new one.

After you sign in

You land on the **Edit Wormholes** page. This is the editor home, the place you will start from every working session. The next sections of this manual all begin from here.

Edit Wormholes

Welcome, Manual Capture (Editor)

Current Galaxy: All my galaxies

View

Logout

Wormholes (17)

New Wormhole

Touched today

Bulk by keyword...

?

Search: Search wormholes...

	Name	Type	Galaxy	Keywords	Acc	Created	Updated	Actions
	Beach Strawberry DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	edible ground-cover native perennial salt-tolerant	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	:
	Sea Lavender DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	flower native perennial salt-tolerant	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	:
	Pacific Wax Myrtle DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	evergreen native salt-tolerant shrub	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	:
	Yellow Bush Lupine ACC DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	flower native nitrogen-fixer perennial	✓	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	:
	Beach Grass DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	ground-cover invasive perennial	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	:
	Sea Rocket DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	annual edible salt-tolerant	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	:
	Coastal Sage DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	drought-tolerant medicinal native perennial	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	:
	Wild Cucumber DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	annual native vine	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	:
	Beach Pea DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	annual flower native nitrogen-fixer	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	:

The page is laid out in two cards:

Top card: who you are, where you are.

- The page title, **Edit Wormholes**, sits at the top left.
- Below the title, a small line greets you by name and confirms your role: *Welcome, Your Name (Editor)*. The role determines what you can do; if you see something this manual describes but cannot reach it, your role does not include that surface, and your operator can adjust it.
- To the right of the title, **Current Galaxy** is a dropdown that picks which galaxy you are currently editing. *All my galaxies* is the default and shows wormholes from every galaxy you have access to. Picking a specific galaxy filters everything below to that one galaxy.
- Next to the dropdown, the **View** button opens your current galaxy in the visitor view (the 3D scene). It is the same view your readers see; it is useful to flip into it from time to time to check that the changes you are making read the way you expect.
- The **Logout** button at the far right ends your session. Telaris keeps your session active across browser restarts unless you log out explicitly.

Bottom card: your wormholes.

- **Wormholes (N)** at the top left tells you how many wormholes are in the current galaxy view. *N* is a number; when you pick *All my galaxies*, it counts across every galaxy.

- **New Wormhole** opens the form to create a new wormhole. Chapter 5 covers this in detail.
- **Touched today** narrows the list to wormholes you have edited since midnight. Useful for picking up where you left off.
- **Bulk by keyword** opens a modal for batch operations across many wormholes at once (delete every wormhole tagged with a keyword, move them all to another galaxy). Chapter 7 covers this surface.
- **?** opens a small panel listing every keyboard shortcut the editor supports. Memorising even two or three will speed up your day; the most useful are **n** (new wormhole), **/** (focus the search box), and **g** (open galaxy settings).
- **Search** filters the wormhole list as you type. It searches across wormhole names, descriptions, galaxy names, and keywords; one search box, all four columns.

The wormhole list itself shows: name, type, galaxy, keywords, an accentuated flag, created date, updated date, and an actions menu. Subsequent chapters explain each column.

Logging out

The **Logout** button at the top right ends your session and returns you to the login page. Telaris will not log you out automatically; if you share a computer, log out at the end of your session.

Things worth knowing

- **Multiple tabs are safe.** You can open the editor in several browser tabs without confusing it. Each tab keeps its own *Current Galaxy* selection.
- **Your session persists across browser restarts** until you explicitly log out or your operator invalidates sessions during maintenance. If you suddenly find yourself back at the login page, this is the most likely reason; sign in again and continue.
- **The mobile experience covers reading and light editing.** Some surfaces (notably the *keyword canvas* covered in chapter 8) are desktop-only. The manual flags each surface as it goes.
- **If a page fails to load:** refresh the browser. If it still fails, that is the moment to talk to your operator.

Concepts

Six words name almost everything in Telaris. Knowing them is enough to read the rest of this manual. Each gets a short page here, with an example drawn from the same sample galaxy ("Coastal plants") used in every screenshot in the rest of the manual.

The concepts are *galaxy*, *wormhole*, *keyword*, *portal*, *keyword canvas*, and *tour*. They build on each other; read them in order the first time, then come back for reference later.

Galaxy

A **galaxy** is a collection of related content. It is the largest unit you work with as an editor. A galaxy has a name, an editorial framing (the short paragraph that opens it for visitors), a visual theme, and any number of wormholes inside it.

A galaxy is **not** a folder. There is no hierarchy; you do not put galaxies inside other galaxies. Galaxies sit beside each other; the relationships *between* galaxies are made by portals and by shared keywords, not by nesting.

IN THE DEMO

"Coastal plants" is one galaxy. It holds twelve wormholes (Beach Strawberry, Sea Lavender, Pacific Wax Myrtle, and so on) plus one portal to a second galaxy called "Tide pools".

Galaxies are the unit that visitors arrive at. A visitor's URL bar typically reads `.../coastal-plants`; that is the slug of the galaxy they are inside. Chapter 4 covers creating and configuring galaxies.

Wormhole

A **wormhole** is the smallest unit of content in Telaris: a single thing the editor wants the reader to see, hear, or read. Most wormholes are about one item: a plant, a photograph, a passage of text, a recording, a film clip.

A wormhole has:

- a **name** (visible everywhere),
- a **description** (the body text shown when a visitor opens it),
- optional **media** (an image, an audio file, a video URL, a PDF, an embed),
- a set of **keywords** that connect it to other wormholes.

A wormhole lives inside exactly one galaxy at a time. If the same idea belongs in two galaxies, you do **not** copy the wormhole; you let the two galaxies share a keyword, or you place a portal. Chapter 12 covers multigalaxy work.

IN THE DEMO

"Beach Strawberry" is a wormhole. Its description tells the visitor what the plant looks like and where it grows; its keywords are *native*, *edible*, *ground-cover*, *perennial*, *salt-tolerant*; it has no media attached yet. Chapter 5 walks through authoring wormholes.

The word "wormhole" carries a specific image: each one is a small opening into a larger conversation. The reader steps through; on the other side is the description, the media, and the keywords that lead to the next opening.

Keyword

A **keyword** is a short label you attach to wormholes. Telaris uses keywords for two purposes, both important:

1. **Connection.** Two wormholes that share a keyword are reachable from each other. The keyword is the conceptual bridge.
2. **Discovery.** Visitors can filter, search, and follow keyword chips to see what else has been tagged with the same word.

A keyword belongs to a galaxy (the canonical place it lives), but **the same word, used in another galaxy, is the same keyword**. Two galaxies that both tag wormholes with *native* connect through that shared word; visitors who follow *native* in one galaxy can find *native*-tagged wormholes in the other.

IN THE DEMO

native is a keyword applied to eight different wormholes in the coastal plants galaxy. *invasive* is applied to three. *intertidal* is applied across both demo galaxies: it links Sea Palm (in coastal plants) to Ochre Sea Star and other animals (in tide pools).

Keywords are the load-bearing material of a Telaris galaxy. They do most of the relational work that, in a hierarchical archive, would be done by folders and breadcrumbs. Chapter 7 covers assigning and shaping keywords.

Portal

A **portal** is a special kind of wormhole. Instead of holding content of its own, a portal points to **another galaxy**. When a visitor opens a portal, they travel

through it: the scene fades, a new galaxy loads, the portal becomes the doorway between the two.

Portals are how you move readers between galaxies on purpose. A keyword shared across galaxies is a *passive* connection (the reader can follow it if they choose). A portal is an *active* connection (the editor says: from here, go there).

IN THE DEMO

The coastal plants galaxy holds a portal wormhole called "To the tide pools". A visitor who opens it lands inside the tide pools galaxy, where they meet Ochre Sea Star, Giant Green Anemone, and the rest.

Portals are not bidirectional. If you want the visitor to be able to come back, place a corresponding portal in the destination galaxy that points the other way. Chapter 9 covers portals in detail.

Keyword canvas

The **keyword canvas** is a drawing surface, separate from the wormhole list, where the editor lays out the keywords of a galaxy and draws relationships between them by hand. Each keyword appears as a coloured chip; you drag the chips around to compose; you draw lines between chips to record that those two keywords belong together; you can attach a short note to any line you draw.

The canvas does not replace the wormhole list; it complements it. The wormhole list is where you author content one wormhole at a time. The canvas is where you author the conceptual map of an entire galaxy.

IN THE DEMO

On the coastal plants canvas, the chips for *native* and *salt-tolerant* sit close together, with a line drawn between them and a note that reads "most natives here tolerate salt." The chips for *invasive* and *native* sit on opposite sides of the canvas, no line; the absence of a connection is also an editorial choice.

The canvas is a desktop-only surface (it does not currently work on phones). Chapter 8 walks through every part of it.

Tour

A **tour** is a curated path a visitor can take through a galaxy. The editor picks the start, picks the order, sets a dwell time at each stop, and decides whether the tour loops back to the beginning or simply ends. Visitors can press a Play

button to start the tour, or the tour can run on its own when the visitor has been idle for a while.

A tour is not a separate object: it is a *configuration* of an existing galaxy. The wormholes the tour visits are the ones already in the galaxy; the tour is what tells the scene which order to visit them in, and how long to sit at each one.

IN THE DEMO

The coastal plants galaxy could host a tour that visits, in order, Beach Strawberry, Sea Rocket, Wild Cucumber, Beach Pea, Yellow Bush Lupine, all of which share *edible* or *nitrogen-fixer*. The visitor presses Play; the scene drifts from one to the next with a five-second pause at each; at the end, it returns to Beach Strawberry and stops.

Chapter 11 covers tours; chapter 10 covers all the other visitor settings that interact with them.

How the concepts fit together

A galaxy holds wormholes. Wormholes carry keywords. Keywords connect wormholes, both within a galaxy and across galaxies that share words. Portals are wormholes that take the visitor from one galaxy to another. The keyword canvas is the drawing where the editor authors the relationships between keywords. A tour is a curated path through a galaxy's wormholes.

If you understand those six relationships, you understand the editor's whole world. The rest of this manual is a series of practical walk-throughs of each one.

Galaxies

A galaxy is a container, a vantage point, and an editorial position all at once. It is the unit your operator hands you when they say "you can edit here"; it is the unit visitors arrive at; it is the unit you frame, name, and shape. This chapter walks through creating a galaxy, configuring it, and the everyday operations on it.

Selecting a galaxy

The **Current Galaxy** dropdown at the top of the editor home is how you pick which galaxy you are working in. *All my galaxies* shows wormholes from everywhere you have access; selecting a specific galaxy filters everything below to that one.

The first thing the dropdown teaches you is the shape of your editorial responsibilities: every galaxy listed is a galaxy you can edit. If a colleague's galaxy is missing, your operator has not assigned it to you. (Visitors of your instance see every public galaxy; editors only see the ones they are responsible for.)

When you pick a specific galaxy, three new buttons appear next to the dropdown:

The screenshot shows the 'Edit Wormholes' interface. At the top, there's a header with 'Edit Wormholes' and 'Welcome, Manual Capture (Editor)'. To the right, it says 'Current Galaxy: [manual-demo] Coastal plants' with buttons for 'View', 'Settings', 'Canvas', and a share icon, plus a 'Logout' button. Below this, there's a section for 'Wormholes (13)' with a 'New Wormhole' button and filters for 'Touched today' and 'Bulk by keyword...'. A search bar is also present. The main part of the interface is a table listing 13 wormholes. Each row includes a radio button, the name (with a 'DESC' link), the type (all are 'Object'), the galaxy name, keywords (in colored tags), an 'Acc' status (checkmark for 'Yellow Bush Lupine'), creation and update timestamps, and an 'Actions' menu (three dots).

	Name	Type	Galaxy	Keywords	Acc	Created	Updated	Actions
☐	Beach Strawberry DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	edible ground-cover native perennial salt-tolerant	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	⋮
☐	Sea Lavender DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	flower native perennial salt-tolerant	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	⋮
☐	Pacific Wax Myrtle DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	evergreen native salt-tolerant shrub	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	⋮
☐	Yellow Bush Lupine ACC DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	flower native nitrogen-fixer perennial	✓	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	⋮
☐	Beach Grass DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	ground-cover invasive perennial	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	⋮
☐	Sea Rocket DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	annual edible salt-tolerant	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	⋮
☐	Coastal Sage DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	drought-tolerant medicinal native perennial	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	⋮
☐	Wild Cucumber DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	annual native vine	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	⋮
☐	Beach Pea DESC	Object	[manual-demo] Coastal plants	annual flower native nitrogen-fixer	—	26-05-21 10:46	26-05-21 10:46	⋮

- **View** opens the galaxy in visitor mode, in a new tab. Use it whenever you want to check how a change reads from the visitor's seat.

- **Settings** opens the galaxy's configuration. Most of this chapter is about what is inside that modal.
- **Canvas** opens the keyword canvas, the relational drawing surface covered in chapter 8.

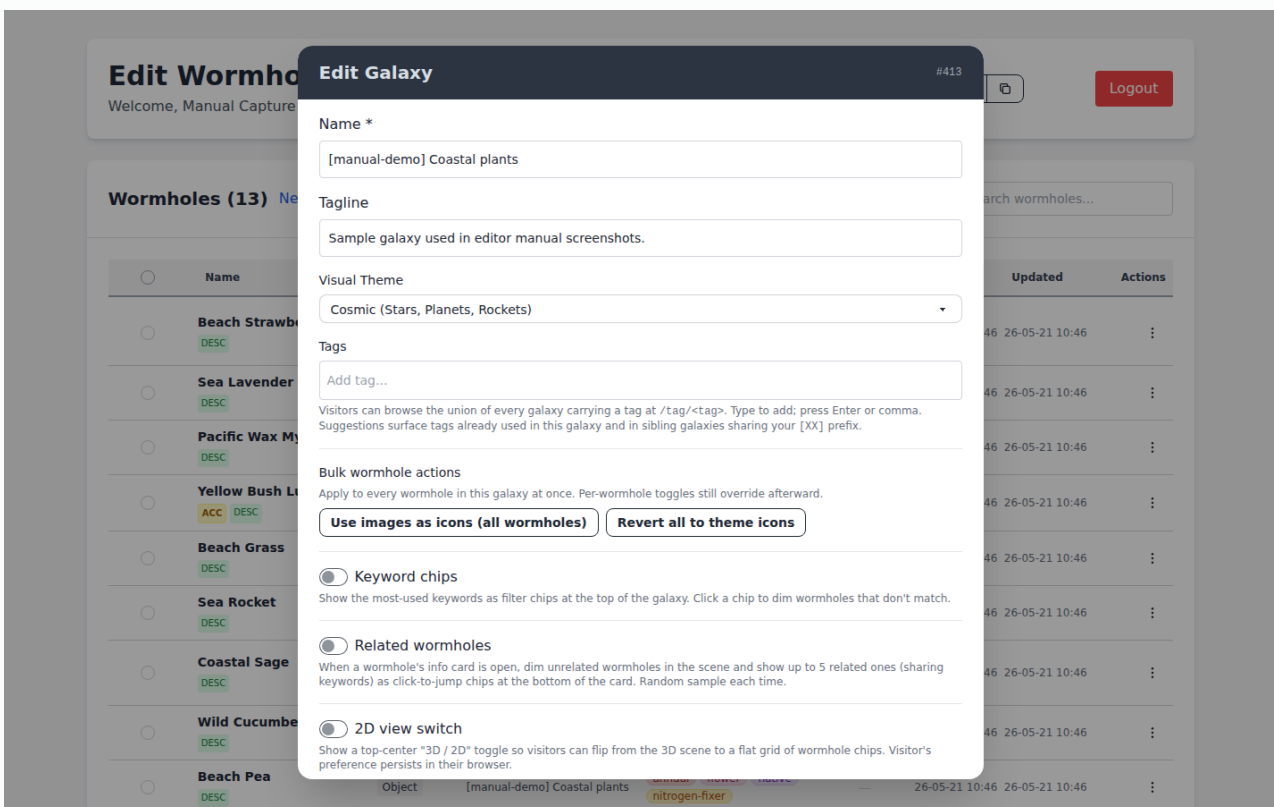
Creating a galaxy

Whether you can create a new galaxy depends on your operator's setup; some instances let editors create galaxies freely, others reserve creation for administrators. If you have permission, the new-galaxy button is in the same row as the picker; if not, ask your operator and they will set one up for you.

When a new galaxy is created, it lands empty: zero wormholes, no keywords, default theme. The next step is to fill in its settings.

Galaxy settings

Open the **Settings** button next to the picker. A modal opens:



The modal is the central place where you shape what a galaxy is and how it behaves. The fields, in order:

Name (required). The name visitors see in the galaxy picker and at the top of the scene. Galaxy names are not unique across the network, but two galaxies with

the same name on the same instance are confusing; choose something readable and distinct. You can change a galaxy's name at any time.

Tagline (optional, short). A one-line description shown next to or below the galaxy name in the visitor's UI. The tagline does not appear in the 3D scene; its main audience is the picker and the public listing.

Visual Theme. A dropdown that picks the look of the 3D scene: *Cosmic* (stars, planets, rockets) is the default and the most common; other themes are *Simple*, *Abstract*, *Rectangles*, *Stripes*, and *Tech*. Pick the one whose vocabulary matches your content. The theme can be changed any time; the change applies to all visitors immediately, but does not alter what you authored, only how it is rendered.

Tags (optional). Short labels that group this galaxy with other galaxies. Two galaxies that share a tag form a *galaxy union*: visitors who follow the tag see wormholes from both at once, with each wormhole keeping the visual style of its source galaxy. Use tags when several galaxies are siblings in some larger arrangement. The Tags input autocompletes from tags you have used in your other galaxies and from tags shared by galaxies prefixed with the same `[bracket]`.

Bulk wormhole actions. Two buttons that apply a single setting across every wormhole in this galaxy at once.

- **Use images as icons (all wormholes)** sets every image-bearing wormhole to render its image as the 3D node instead of the theme's default icon. Useful when you have a galaxy of photographs and want the photos to *be* the scene.
- **Revert all to theme icons** undoes the above: every wormhole goes back to the theme's icon, regardless of whether it has an image.

These act in bulk; individual wormholes can still be flipped one at a time afterwards (chapter 5).

Discovery toggles. A set of switches at the bottom of the modal that control how the visitor experiences your galaxy. They are off by default; turn each one on when you want the corresponding feature. Each toggle is covered in chapter 10 (Visitor views) where the feature it controls is also shown.

Save the modal with **Save**; close without changes via **Cancel** or by clicking outside the modal. Changes apply to visitors immediately.

Editorial framing

A galaxy's framing is the short paragraph that opens it for visitors. It is the answer to the question *what is this galaxy?* before the visitor has met any wormhole. Two places to write it:

1. The **Tagline** field in the galaxy modal, for the one-line summary that appears next to the galaxy name.
2. (Some instances) a dedicated framing wormhole inside the galaxy, often the first one a visitor sees on entry. If your instance uses this pattern, your operator will let you know.

Both are editorial choices, not technical ones. Write the framing in your own voice; the galaxy is yours to introduce.

Sharing wormholes across galaxies through tags

If you have a galaxy whose content is part of a larger constellation of work (an exhibit with several rooms; a journal with several issues; a series of related collections), the **Tags** field is how you say so. Add the same tag to each galaxy that belongs together; the union becomes reachable to visitors at

`/tag/<tag-slug>` (your operator can share the link).

Tags do not create or modify wormholes. They are purely a viewing arrangement: in the union view, the visitor sees the wormholes of every tagged galaxy together, but each wormhole stays in its home galaxy. Edit one galaxy, the others are unchanged.

Retiring a galaxy

There is no "delete galaxy" button for editors in the typical instance setup; if you genuinely need to retire a galaxy, ask your operator and they will arrange it. The reason for the friction is editorial: a galaxy that has been linked to from outside (by a tour, by a portal, by a tag union, by a visitor's bookmark) does not simply disappear; the link goes dark. The operator can decide how to handle the dark link.

The most common pattern is not to delete a galaxy but to make it invisible to visitors while keeping it in the editor side, so the editorial decision can be reversed later.

Things worth knowing

- **You cannot move a galaxy.** Once a galaxy has a slug (the `/<short-name>` part of the URL), the slug is permanent. Renaming the galaxy changes the display name

but not the slug. If a slug change is critical, the operator can arrange one, but the URL changes for everyone with the old link.

- **The galaxy picker groups galaxies with the same [bracket] prefix.** If your instance uses bracket prefixes ([mocambos] Galaxy A , [mocambos] Galaxy B), the picker groups them visually. The brackets are a convention, not a feature; use them when grouping helps your editors find related galaxies.
- **A galaxy with zero wormholes is allowed.** New galaxies start empty and remain editable. There is no requirement to have a minimum number of wormholes before saving.
- **The visual theme changes only the scene appearance.** Switching from Cosmic to Tech does not change what is in the galaxy; it changes how the wormholes are *drawn*. Try a theme; if it does not fit, switch back.

Wormholes

A wormhole is the smallest unit of content in Telaris. Everything an editor publishes is, in the end, a wormhole: a passage of text, a photograph, an audio recording, a film clip, a PDF, a quotation, a single thought. This chapter walks through creating one, editing one, the fields that shape it, and the choices the form invites you to make.

Creating a new wormhole

From the editor home, select the galaxy you are working in, then choose **New Wormhole**. A modal opens:

Add New Wormhole

Name *
Primary title of the wormhole shown in the network.

Galaxy
Which galaxy this wormhole belongs to.

Wormhole type
Object is a standard item; Portal links to another galaxy.

Keywords
Add keyword...
Type and press Enter or comma to add keywords. Suggestions surface keywords already used in this galaxy and in sibling galaxies sharing your [XX] prefix.

Accentuate Wormhole
Make this wormhole larger and more prominent in the network.

Show Keywords
Display this wormhole's keywords in its info window.

Description
Detailed text displayed when the wormhole is selected.

URL
URL to open when the wormhole is clicked (optional).

Primary visual
Pick one. Switching tabs and saving clears the others.

Image URL / File
Use as wormhole icon

Icon URL / File
Choose File No file chosen
Custom icon displayed in the 3D scene (overrides theme icon).

Audio URL / File

The form has four broad regions, in order of how far down the modal you scroll:

1. **Identity** at the top: Name, Galaxy, Wormhole type, Keywords.
2. **Behaviour switches**: Accentuate, Show Keywords.
3. **Body**: Description, URL.
4. **Media**: image, video, audio, PDF, and the icon override.

Save with the button at the bottom of the modal; the new wormhole appears in the list immediately. Cancel or click outside the modal to discard.

Identity fields

Name

Required. The label the visitor reads in the 3D scene, in any list, and in the URL when they share it. Choose a name that reads cleanly on its own; it will be quoted out of context more often than you think.

Names within a galaxy must be unique; the modal will warn you if a name is taken before you save. Across galaxies, two wormholes can share a name without conflict.

Galaxy

Required, but usually pre-filled. The dropdown shows every galaxy you can edit. If you started from a specific galaxy in the editor home, that galaxy is selected by default; if you started from *All my galaxies*, you choose here.

Changing the galaxy in this dropdown **moves** the wormhole to that galaxy. The wormhole's keywords come along with it, but its keyword *positions* on the destination galaxy's canvas may need re-touching.

Wormhole type

A dropdown with two values:

- **Object** is the default and the right answer for almost every wormhole. An Object holds content (description, media).
- **Portal** turns the wormhole into a doorway to another galaxy. Selecting Portal reveals a second dropdown for the target galaxy. Chapter 9 covers portals.

Keywords

A chip input. Type a keyword and press **Enter** (or comma) to add it; click the **x** on a chip to remove it. Suggestions appear as you type, drawn from:

- Keywords already used elsewhere in **this** galaxy.
- Keywords used in galaxies that share your galaxy's `[bracket]` prefix.

Choose keywords with the visitor's path in mind: each keyword you attach is a doorway from this wormhole to every other wormhole that shares the same word. The fewer keywords you assign, the more deliberate each connection feels; the more you assign, the denser the web. Chapter 7 covers keyword strategy.

Behaviour switches

Accentuate Wormhole

Off by default. When on, this wormhole renders larger and more prominent in the 3D scene. Use sparingly: if you accentuate everything, nothing is accentuated. The accentuated flag is also the marker the auto-tour feature can use to pick its stops (chapter 11).

Show Keywords

Off by default. When on, the visitor sees this wormhole's keywords printed next to it in the 3D scene, before they open it. Useful for wormholes whose role in the galaxy is best understood through its tags (a reference document; a navigation hint; a definition).

Body

Description

The text the visitor reads when they open the wormhole. There is no length cap; one-line wormholes and long-form essays are both supported. The field accepts basic markdown formatting: paragraphs (a blank line), **bold**, *italics*, [\[link\]\(https://...\)](#), lists, and inline `code`. Headings and embedded media are not rendered inside the description; if you need a heading-like break, leave a blank line and start a new paragraph.

Write descriptions in your own voice. Telaris does not edit what you write; the platform frames the content, the content is yours.

URL

Optional. If you fill this in, the wormhole becomes clickable as a link out: when the visitor opens the wormhole's info card, an *Open Link* button appears that takes them to the URL in a new tab.

Use this for source-of-truth references (a paper, a book page, a sound archive, a community website). Leave it empty when the wormhole is self-contained.

Media

A wormhole can carry one **primary visual** plus an optional **audio** track and an optional **icon override**. The primary visual is what visitors see at the top of the info card when they open the wormhole; the audio plays in the background; the icon override changes how the wormhole appears in the 3D scene.

The modal organises the primary visual as a set of tabs: **Image**, **Video (MP4)**, **PDF**. Picking one and saving clears the others; only one primary visual at a time. Chapter 6 covers each tab in detail.

The audio field is independent of the primary visual; a wormhole with an image and an audio file plays the audio while the image is visible. Embed code (e.g., a Spotify or Vimeo iframe) is supported as an alternative to image / video / PDF when the visual is hosted externally.

Editing an existing wormhole

To edit a wormhole, click anywhere on its row in the wormhole list, or open its row actions menu and choose **Edit**:

Edit Wormhole #279

Name *
Beach Strawberry

Galaxy
[manual-demo] Coastal plants

Wormhole type
Object

Keywords
edible × ground-cover × native ×
perennial × salt-tolerant × Add keyword...

Type and press Enter or comma to add keywords. Suggestions surface keywords already used in this galaxy and in sibling galaxies sharing your [XX] prefix.

☐ Accentuate Wormhole
Make this wormhole larger and more prominent in the network.

☐ Show Keywords
Display this wormhole's keywords in its info window.

Description
Low-growing perennial with white flowers and small red fruit. Spreads along the sand by runners; tolerates salt spray; native to the Pacific coast.

URL
https://example.com

Media

Primary visual
Image Video (MP4) PDF
Pick one. Switching tabs and saving clears the others.

Image URL / File
https://example.com/image.jpg

Use as wormhole icon ☐

Icon URL / File
https://example.com/icon.png
Choose File No file chosen
Custom icon displayed in the 3D scene (overrides theme icon).

Audio URL / File

The modal is the same as the create form, with the existing values populated. The wormhole's id appears in the upper-right corner (here, #279); editors rarely need to refer to ids, but the number is useful when reporting a problem to your operator.

Save persists the change immediately. Visitors viewing the galaxy see your update on their next page load.

Duplicating, viewing, deleting

The actions menu on each wormhole row offers four operations:

- **View** opens a read-only preview of the wormhole's info card as the visitor would see it. Use this whenever you want to check a change before treating the work as done.
- **Edit** opens the modal above.
- **Duplicate** creates a copy of the wormhole, with the same content, in the same galaxy, named "Original Name (Copy)". The new wormhole gets a fresh position in the 3D scene; everything else carries over. Useful when you want a near-duplicate as a starting point.
- **Delete** removes the wormhole. A confirmation modal appears first; deletes are permanent (your operator can sometimes restore from a snapshot, but the answer should be: do not delete unless you mean it).

Things worth knowing

- **Save before switching galaxies in the dropdown** if you are mid-edit; switching may close the modal without saving.
- **The 3D scene position is automatic.** Each wormhole gets a position assigned by the system at create time. You do not need to choose where the wormhole sits in space; the layout is generated. To re-randomise a wormhole's position, Duplicate it and delete the original (the duplicate gets a new position).
- **Keywords are case-insensitive matches.** "Native" and "native" are the same keyword; the chip will use whichever case was used first in the galaxy.
- **A wormhole without a description is allowed but quiet.** Visitors who open it see only the name. Use this pattern when the wormhole's job is purely visual (an image-only postcard) or when it serves as a navigation hint.
- **A wormhole's keyword chips are coloured deterministically** by the keyword text. The same keyword always gets the same pastel across every galaxy on your instance; this is intentional, so visitors can recognise *native* by colour as well as by spelling.
- **Imported wormholes are read-only.** If your instance imports content from an external source (a sister archive, an upstream community), those wormholes appear in your editor list but cannot be edited; the edit modal opens in a viewer state. The change has to happen at the source.

Adding media

A wormhole's body is the description; its **media** is everything visual or sonic the visitor encounters alongside the body: an image, a film clip, a sound recording, a PDF document, an embedded player from another site. This chapter walks through each kind, in the order the modal presents them.

A wormhole carries at most **one primary visual** at a time. Image, Video, and PDF are three tabs in the modal that share a single underlying slot; picking one and saving clears the others. The fourth media type, **audio**, is independent of the primary visual: a wormhole with an image *and* an audio track plays the audio while the image stays on screen.

The Image tab

The default tab, and the most common media choice. Use it for photographs, illustrations, scans, diagrams, anything still.

Add New Wormhole

Name *
Primary title of the wormhole shown in the network.

Galaxy
[manual-demo] Coastal plants
Which galaxy this wormhole belongs to.

Wormhole type
Object
Object is a standard item; Portal links to another galaxy.

Keywords
Add keyword...
Type and press Enter or comma to add keywords. Suggestions surface keywords already used in this galaxy and in sibling galaxies sharing your [XX] prefix.

Accentuate Wormhole
Make this wormhole larger and more prominent in the network.

Show Keywords
Display this wormhole's keywords in its info window.

Description
Detailed text displayed when the wormhole is selected.

URL
https://example.com
URL to open when the wormhole is clicked (optional).

Primary visual
Image Video (MP4) PDF
Pick one. Switching tabs and saving clears the others.

Image URL / File
https://example.com/image.jpg

Use as wormhole icon ☒

Icon URL / File
https://example.com/icon.png
Choose File No file chosen
Custom icon displayed in the 3D scene (overrides theme icon).

Audio URL / File

Two ways to attach an image:

- **Image URL:** paste the address of an image hosted elsewhere on the web. Use when the image's home is somewhere stable (a museum archive, a community website, a CDN under your control). The URL must point at the image itself, not at a page containing the image.

- **File picker:** choose **Choose File** and upload an image from your computer. Telaris keeps the uploaded file on your instance and serves it back to visitors.

Either way, the image becomes the visitor's primary visual when they open the wormhole.

Use as wormhole icon is a toggle below the image fields. When on, the image replaces the theme's default 3D node icon: visitors see the image as the wormhole in the 3D scene, not just inside the info card. Useful when the image is the wormhole's identity (a portrait, a cover, a logo). When off, the 3D scene shows the theme's default icon and the image only appears inside the opened info card.

Image attribution is a small free-text field that travels with the image. Use it for photographer credit, source archive, licence note, anything that would attach to the image if it appeared in a printed book. Visitors see it next to the image in the info card.

The Video tab

Use for film clips, recorded interviews, animations, anything that moves. Telaris supports MP4 only at this stage; other formats (WebM, MOV, AVI) need to be transcoded first or hosted on a video service and embedded (see Embed code below).

Add New Wormhole

Name *

 Primary title of the wormhole shown in the network.

Galaxy

 Which galaxy this wormhole belongs to.

Wormhole type

 Object is a standard item; Portal links to another galaxy.

Keywords

 Type and press Enter or comma to add keywords. Suggestions surface keywords already used in this galaxy and in sibling galaxies sharing your [XX] prefix.

☐ **Accentuate Wormhole**
 Make this wormhole larger and more prominent in the network.

☐ **Show Keywords**
 Display this wormhole's keywords in its info window.

Description

 Detailed text displayed when the wormhole is selected.

URL

 URL to open when the wormhole is clicked (optional).

Primary visual
☐ Image ☐ Video (MP4) ☐ PDF
 Pick one. Switching tabs and saving clears the others.

No file chosen

Icon URL / File

 No file chosen
 Custom icon displayed in the 3D scene (overrides theme icon).

Audio URL / File

 No file chosen

Same two paths as image: paste a URL to an MP4 hosted elsewhere, or upload a file. Once the wormhole is saved, the visitor's info card shows a video player with standard controls (play, pause, scrub, volume, full-screen).

Sizing matters. Video files are typically much larger than images; an instance's upload limit may stop you well before you exhaust your patience. If the upload fails, ask your operator about the limit or host the video externally and use the URL field.

If your video lives on a streaming service (Vimeo, YouTube, archive.org), the Embed code field below is the right tool, not the Video tab.

The PDF tab

For documents: papers, field guides, photocopies, reports, score sheets, manuscripts.

Add New Wormhole

Name *
Primary title of the wormhole shown in the network.

Galaxy
[manual-demo] Coastal plants
Which galaxy this wormhole belongs to.

Wormhole type
Object
Object is a standard item; Portal links to another galaxy.

Keywords
Add keyword...
Type and press Enter or comma to add keywords. Suggestions surface keywords already used in this galaxy and in sibling galaxies sharing your [XX] prefix.

Accentuate Wormhole
Make this wormhole larger and more prominent in the network.

Show Keywords
Display this wormhole's keywords in its info window.

Description
Detailed text displayed when the wormhole is selected.

URL
https://example.com
URL to open when the wormhole is clicked (optional).

Primary visual
Image Video (MP4) PDF
Pick one. Switching tabs and saving clears the others.

Icon URL / File
https://example.com/icon.png
Choose File No file chosen
Custom icon displayed in the 3D scene (overrides theme icon).

Audio URL / File

Choose File No file chosen

Same two paths. Once saved, the visitor's info card embeds an in-page PDF reader: they can scroll the document, search it, copy text, and download it (the standard PDF viewer affordances).

PDF uploads have a size cap set by your operator (commonly 25 MB). If your file is larger, either split it, host it externally and link with the URL field, or ask your operator to raise the cap.

Audio

The Audio field appears below the primary-visual tabs. It is independent of the image / video / PDF choice; a wormhole can have any combination of audio and one primary visual.

- **Audio URL / File:** paste an URL to an audio file or upload one. MP3 is the safest choice; many browsers also support OGG and WAV.

When audio is attached, two toggles control playback:

- **Autoplay:** when on, the audio starts as soon as the visitor opens the wormhole's info card. When off, the visitor sees a play button and starts the audio themselves. Autoplay is usually right for short, ambient, or atmospheric tracks; off is right for spoken-word, music, anything that demands attention.
- **Loop:** when on, the audio restarts from the beginning each time it finishes. Use for ambient loops, drones, soundscapes; turn off for any audio with a narrative arc.

The audio plays in the background of the info card; the visitor can pause or scrub it at any time using the standard audio controls.

Embed code

The fourth media path, for content hosted on another service that already provides an embed snippet: a Vimeo iframe, a Spotify player, a SoundCloud track, an archive.org viewer, a SketchFab 3D scene.

Find the **Embed code** field (below the primary-visual tabs) and paste the snippet exactly as the host gives it to you. Telaris does not transform or sanitise embed code; what you paste is what visitors get. Test the wormhole afterwards by opening it in a visitor view; if the embed is broken, the field is the place to fix it.

Embed code and the primary visual are not mutually exclusive (the embed appears separately in the info card), but for clarity it usually makes sense to pick one or the other.

The icon override

Below the media fields, an **Icon URL / File** appears. This sets the wormhole's appearance in the 3D scene, *separately* from the primary visual. Use it when:

- You want a custom 3D icon (a small graphic that represents the wormhole at scene scale), distinct from the larger image visitors see inside the info card.
- The Use-as-wormhole-icon toggle on the Image tab is not enough because you have an Image *and* you want the scene icon to be something else.

Most editors do not need this; the theme's default icons cover most cases. When you do need it, supply a small square image (PNG or SVG) and Telaris uses it in the 3D scene.

Storage and what travels with a wormhole

Uploaded media is stored on your instance. Each wormhole's uploads live under a folder identified by the wormhole's id; restoring a snapshot brings uploads with it, deleting a wormhole removes its uploads.

URL-linked media stays at its original host; if the host removes the file, the wormhole's media goes dark. Editors with valuable external references should consider uploading the file rather than linking, so the archive survives the original host.

Things worth knowing

- **Switching between primary-visual tabs clears the field you were on.** A safety prompt before saving warns you about this. If you change your mind, switch back before saving.
- **Audio that loops can be jarring on first visit.** If you ship an audio loop, listen to the boundary (the moment the loop restarts); the seam is what visitors will notice.
- **An image at high resolution is more useful than at low.** Telaris scales images down for the 3D scene automatically; uploading at full quality means a sharper info-card view, and means future format changes do not need re-uploading.
- **PDF text is searchable in the in-page viewer**, but only if the PDF itself has a text layer. Scanned documents without OCR are flat images inside a PDF wrapper; the search box will find nothing.
- **Video files do not stream by chunks:** when a visitor opens the wormhole, the entire file downloads. Keep video files short and well-compressed.

- **External embeds may break over time.** Services change their embed format, deprecate players, or remove content. A wormhole that depends on an embed is a wormhole whose half-life is shorter than one whose media lives on your instance.

Keywords

Keywords are short labels you attach to wormholes. They are how Telaris connects content without folders. A keyword is the difference between a galaxy that is a *list* and a galaxy that is a *web*; everything else, in the editor's day-to-day, is built on top.

This chapter covers assigning keywords from inside the wormhole modal, the chip palette, and the bulk operations for working with many wormholes at once. The keyword **canvas** (the relational drawing surface for keywords) is its own chapter (8).

Assigning keywords

Keywords are assigned inside the wormhole modal, in the **Keywords** field next to the wormhole's name (see chapter 5 for the full modal). The field is a chip input:

- Type a keyword and press **Enter** or **comma** to add it as a chip.
- Click the **×** on a chip to remove it.
- The same keyword can be added in any case; Telaris matches case-insensitively, so *native* and *Native* are the same keyword.

As you type, suggestions appear:

- Keywords already used in **this galaxy** appear first.
- Keywords used in **sibling galaxies** (galaxies that share the `[bracket]` prefix of your current galaxy) appear next.
- Other recent keywords appear last.

Accepting a suggestion is the same as typing the word fully. Telaris does not require you to use suggestions; you can always type a fresh keyword, in which case the new keyword joins the galaxy.

Choosing keywords well

The most important keyword decision is **how few to use**. A wormhole tagged with three carefully chosen keywords is more legible than one tagged with twenty. Every keyword you add is a connection to every other wormhole carrying the same word; if the connection is not meaningful, the visitor's path through the galaxy gets noisier.

Some practical rules:

- **One per quality the wormhole genuinely embodies.** *Native* on a plant that is native; *edible* on one that is genuinely eaten. Not *plant* on every wormhole in a plant galaxy; that keyword carries no signal.
- **Reuse before inventing.** When two editors describe the same idea with different words (*medicinal* and *healing*), the conceptual link goes dark. Look at the autocomplete; if a word close to yours already exists, prefer it.
- **Avoid keywords you would never search.** A keyword nobody (visitor or editor) would type into a search box is one that does no work.

There is no review queue and no central vocabulary. Each editor decides the keywords on each wormhole; the system trusts you. Chapter 13 talks about editorial sovereignty in detail.

The chip palette

Each keyword gets a deterministic pastel colour, chosen by the keyword's text. The colour is the **same** for that word across every galaxy on your instance: visitors who learn that *native* is the green-ish chip in one galaxy will recognise it instantly in another.

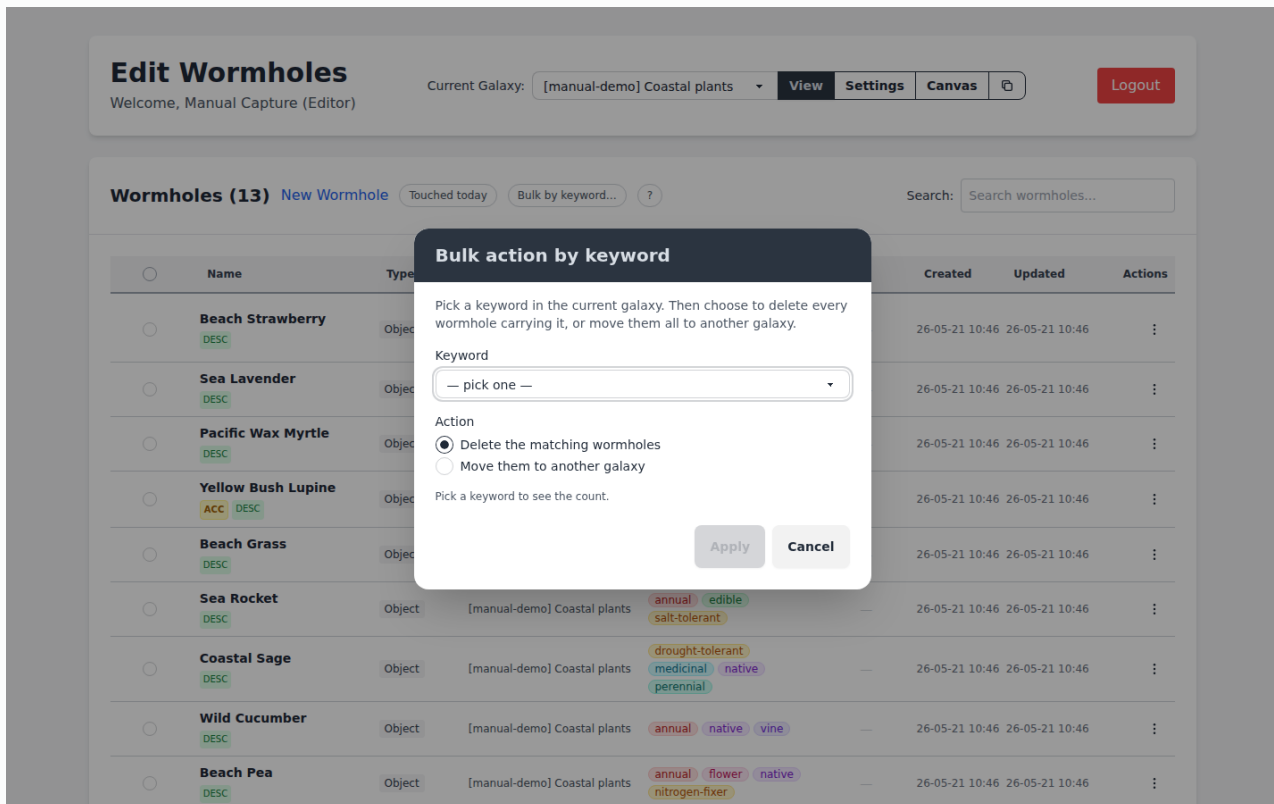
This is also why renaming a keyword changes the colour: the colour is keyed to the text, not to an internal id. If you rename *medicinal* to *healing*, the chip's colour shifts. (Practically: rename rarely; merging is a cleaner operation.)

Editing keywords on an existing wormhole

Open the wormhole's Edit modal (chapter 5). The Keywords field shows the existing chips. Add chips as above; remove with the ×; save. Changes apply on the visitor's next page load.

Bulk operations: the Bulk-by-keyword modal

When you need to act on **every wormhole carrying a given keyword** at once, the Bulk by keyword modal is the surface. Open it from the editor home, in the row of buttons next to **New Wormhole**:



The modal scopes to the **current galaxy**: it can only act on wormholes inside the galaxy you have selected. Steps:

1. **Pick a keyword** from the dropdown. The dropdown lists every keyword in the galaxy, with its usage count next to each. Telaris updates the wormhole count below as you change selection, so you always know what the action will hit.
2. **Choose an action**:
 - **Delete the matching wormholes** removes every wormhole carrying the chosen keyword. The deletes are permanent (the same caveat as in chapter 5 applies; ask the operator about a snapshot before doing anything irreversible).
 - **Move them to another galaxy** appears with an additional dropdown when selected. The wormholes are transferred to the chosen galaxy along with their keywords and media.
3. **Apply** runs the operation. **Cancel** dismisses without changes.

The Bulk modal is a sharp tool. Two ways to make it less sharp:

- Take a snapshot before the operation, if your operator has set you up to take snapshots, or ask them to take one.
- Run a quick search (the search box on the editor home) for the keyword before opening the modal, so you can see exactly which wormholes will be affected and confirm none of them are kept-by-mistake.

Aliases (per-galaxy synonyms)

Telaris's keyword model treats two galaxies' use of the same word as the **same keyword**. There is no per-galaxy alias mechanism in v1 of the rollout; if you want *medicinal* in one galaxy to be treated as the same keyword as *healing* in another, the practical move is to **rename one to match the other** so both galaxies converge on a single word.

If the editorial intent is precisely the opposite (a word that means different things in two galaxies and should not connect them), use different words in each galaxy. Conceptual precision is more useful than syntactic cleverness here.

Keyword counts in the visitor view

When the galaxy's **Keyword chips** discovery feature is on (chapter 4 covers the toggle; chapter 10 covers the resulting visitor experience), the visitor sees a row of chips at the bottom of the 3D scene showing the most-used keywords. Clicking a chip dims every wormhole that does *not* carry that keyword.

This is a soft filter (it does not remove wormholes from the scene, just dim them), and it is one of the main ways visitors navigate a galaxy without instructions. The keywords you choose are the navigation: clear keywords mean a clear scene.

Things worth knowing

- **A wormhole without keywords is allowed but quiet.** Visitors can still reach it through name search or by 3D-clicking; they will not reach it through the keyword chip layer. Use zero keywords when the wormhole's role is purely solitary.
- **Keyword names are searched in the editor home search box** alongside wormhole names and descriptions. Searching for a keyword is the fastest way to audit which wormholes carry it.
- **Renaming a keyword updates it everywhere on the instance.** Renaming *medicinal* renames it in every galaxy that uses the word. There is no per-galaxy rename.
- **Deleting a keyword removes it from every wormhole that carries it.** The wormholes survive; the keyword chip drops off them. Deletes happen through the keyword canvas (chapter 8); they are not in the Bulk by keyword modal, which deletes wormholes, not keywords.
- **There is no maximum number of keywords per wormhole**, but practical legibility suggests three to seven is plenty. Past ten, the chip strip on the info card starts to wrap awkwardly.

The keyword canvas

The keyword canvas is where you author the conceptual map of a galaxy. Wormholes give you objects; keywords give you ways to tag those objects; the canvas is where you draw, by hand, the relationships **between the keywords themselves**. Two chips lean closer because the editor decided they belong closer. Two chips have a line drawn between them because the editor decided to say *these two ideas are linked, and here is why*.

This chapter walks through the surface, its drawing affordances, and the editorial discipline of using it well.

Opening the canvas

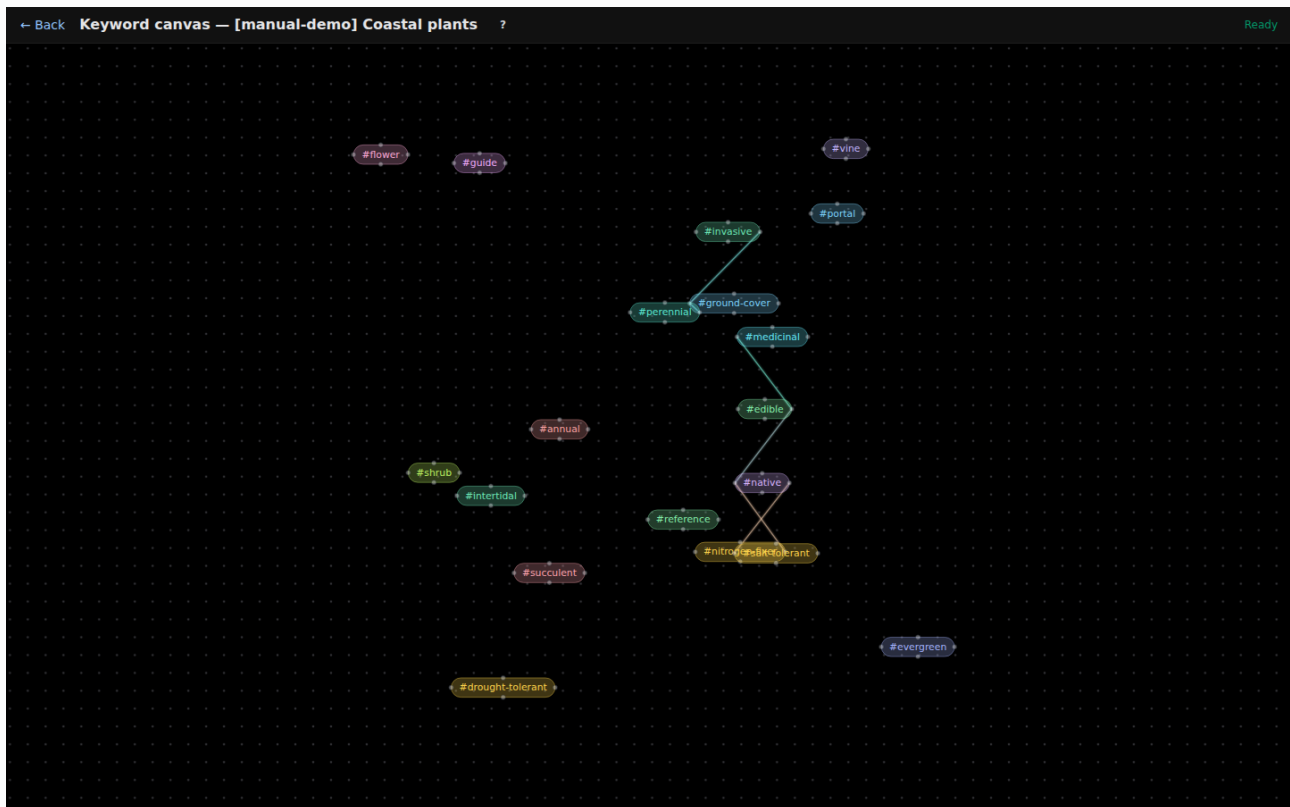
Select the galaxy you want to work on from the editor home. When a specific galaxy is selected, three buttons appear next to the galaxy picker; the third is **Canvas**. Select it. The canvas opens in a new tab.

DESKTOP ONLY

The canvas is a desktop-only surface. On a phone or tablet, the chip and line interactions do not behave well; the Canvas button is hidden in those contexts. If you need to work on a galaxy's keyword arrangement from a small screen, the wormhole list and the keyword field inside each wormhole modal still work; the canvas does not.

What you see

The canvas opens in a full-viewport dark scene with the galaxy's keywords laid out as pastel chips on a dot grid:



Each chip is one keyword. The colour of the chip matches the colour used elsewhere in the app: *native* is the same green-ish here as on a wormhole row. Chips drift slightly when the canvas is idle (a soft physics simulation keeps them alive); dragging a chip pins it in place from then on.

Lines between chips are **relations** the editor has drawn. Each line has two endpoints (the chips it connects), an optional note (a sentence explaining the connection), and a record of who drew it and when.

The top bar carries:

- **Back**: returns you to the editor home for this galaxy.
- The galaxy name.
- **?**: opens a small help overlay listing every canvas keyboard and mouse interaction.
- **Ready** (or **Saving...**): a small status indicator confirming the canvas has saved your most recent change.

Drawing a relation

Two ways to draw a line between two chips:

1. **Click-click**: click one chip's anchor dot (a small circle that appears on the chip when you hover), then click another chip's anchor dot. A line snaps into place.

2. **Drag:** press on one chip's anchor dot and drag to the other chip; release.
Same result.

When the line appears, a small inline input lets you type an optional note. Enter saves the note; Escape leaves the line without a note. The note is visible when a visitor (or another editor) hovers the line later.

The line **sticks to the chip edges** as you move chips around. Drag the *native* chip across the canvas; the line to *salt-tolerant* follows. There is no manual line routing; the geometry takes care of itself.

Moving and arranging chips

- **Drag** a chip to reposition it. The new position is saved automatically.
- The canvas remembers position **per editor**: each editor has their own view of the canvas. Two editors working on the same galaxy do not fight over chip positions; each sees their own arrangement, and the visitor view uses the most recent or a merged layout (consult your operator about your instance's setting).
- Chips that you have not moved float in a gentle drift, slowly settling into a layout influenced by their relation lines (chips connected by a line are softly pulled towards each other). The drift stops once you drag a chip; from that moment on, the chip is pinned.

This is the canvas's small secret: the layout you see is partly the work of the simulation and partly the editorial choices you have made. Two galaxies whose editors have drawn no relations at all look like dust on the dot grid; two galaxies whose editors have drawn many look like constellations.

Editing or deleting a relation

Hover a line; a small context menu appears with two options:

- **Edit note:** change the inline note attached to the line.
- **Delete:** remove the relation entirely.

Deletes are permanent at the line level (no undo within the canvas), but the chip endpoints remain on the canvas. You can re-draw a relation between the same two chips later; the new line is a fresh row in the underlying record, not a restoration of the old one.

Renaming and merging keywords

Right-click (or long-press on touch) a chip to open its options:

- **Rename:** change the word. The rename applies to every wormhole carrying the keyword across every galaxy on the instance, because keywords are global by text. The chip's colour shifts to match the new text (colours are deterministic by the word).
- **Merge into...:** select another chip on the canvas to merge this keyword into. After the merge, every wormhole that carried the source keyword now carries the target keyword instead. The source chip disappears.
- **Delete:** removes the keyword from every wormhole that carried it on the instance.

These are sharp tools. Merging is the kindest of the three (no data loss; just relabelling), then renaming (also no data loss; the word changes but the connections stay), then deleting (the keyword goes away; the wormholes survive without it). Operate on a quiet day if a galaxy has many editors.

Bulk reset

The canvas exposes two bulk-reset operations through the ? help overlay:

- **Reset all chip positions** in this galaxy: every chip goes back to a uniform default position. Use when the layout has accumulated cruft and you want to start over.
- **Reset all relations** in this galaxy: deletes every relation line in this galaxy. The chips remain. Use when you want to re-draw the conceptual map from scratch.

Both are scoped to the **current galaxy**; they do not touch other galaxies.

When to use the canvas (and when not to)

The canvas is most useful when:

- A galaxy's keywords carry a structure worth showing (some are siblings, some are opposites, some are scoped specifically to a sub-region of the content).
- An editorial point lives **between** keywords rather than inside a single one. *Native* on its own is just a label; *native* drawn close to *salt-tolerant* with a note ("most natives here tolerate salt") is an observation.
- You want a working surface to think on. The canvas is a sketchpad for the galaxy's vocabulary as well as a public artefact.

The canvas is **less useful** for:

- Tiny galaxies (under ten wormholes; the chip count is usually too small for a layout to be interesting).
- Galaxies whose keywords are mostly proper nouns or unique to one wormhole; the canvas is for relationships *between* concepts, and one-off concepts have nothing to relate to.

If a galaxy never feels like it warrants opening the canvas, that is a fine outcome. The canvas is offered, not required.

Things worth knowing

- **The canvas saves every change automatically.** There is no Save button. The **Saving...** / **Ready** indicator at the top right reflects the persistence state.
- **No undo within the canvas surface.** A wrong move is corrected by another move; an accidental delete by re-drawing the line. If something goes badly wrong, ask your operator about a snapshot.
- **The visitor does not see the chips directly.** The canvas is an editor's surface; what visitors see in the 3D scene is influenced by the keyword arrangement (which wormholes share keywords; which chips have relations), but visitors do not look at the chip grid itself.
- **Line notes are surfaced to visitors only on hover** in the related-wormholes panel (chapter 10 has the visitor-side detail). The note is part of the public artefact; write it for a future reader, not for yourself.

Portals

A portal is a special kind of wormhole. Instead of carrying its own content, it carries a destination: another galaxy. A visitor who opens a portal travels through it. The scene fades, a new galaxy loads, the portal closes behind them. Portals are how an editor builds intentional bridges between galaxies.

This chapter covers when to use a portal versus a shared keyword, how to create one, and the small set of editorial conventions that keep a portal network legible.

When a portal is the right tool

Telaris already gives you two ways to connect content across galaxies:

1. **Shared keywords:** a wormhole in galaxy A and a wormhole in galaxy B both tagged *intertidal* form a *passive* connection. A visitor who follows *intertidal* in either galaxy lands on a view that shows both.
2. **Galaxy tags:** galaxy A and galaxy B sharing the tag *coast* create a union; visitors who follow `/tag/coast` see both galaxies' wormholes together.

A portal is a third kind of connection, and a much more *active* one: the editor says, in effect, *from this wormhole, go there now*. It is the right tool when:

- The connection is **directional and deliberate**. A shared keyword is a network; a portal is an arrow.
- The destination galaxy is a **continuation of the conversation**, not just a related topic. The reader should leave their current galaxy and arrive in another, not browse both at once.
- You want the portal itself to **show up in the 3D scene** as a navigable object. A portal renders as a distinct 3D node; visitors can recognise it and click it deliberately.

If none of those are true, a keyword or a galaxy tag is usually a better choice.

Creating a portal

A portal is a wormhole whose Wormhole type is set to **Portal**. From the New Wormhole modal:

Edit Wormhole
Welcome, Manual

Add New Wormhole

Name *
Primary title of the wormhole shown in the network.

Galaxy
Which galaxy this wormhole belongs to.
[manual-demo] Coastal plants

Wormhole type
Object is a standard item: Portal links to another galaxy.
Portal

Keywords
Add keyword...
Type and press Enter or comma to add keywords. Suggestions surface keywords already used in this galaxy and in sibling galaxies sharing your [XX] prefix.

☐ **Accentuate Wormhole**
Make this wormhole larger and more prominent in the network.

☐ **Show Keywords**
Display this wormhole's keywords in its info window.

Target Galaxy
The destination galaxy this portal leads to.
[manual-demo] Coastal plants
[Create New Galaxy](#)

Description
Detailed text displayed when the wormhole is selected.

URL
https://example.com
URL to open when the wormhole is clicked (optional).

Primary visual
Image Video (MP4) PDF

Icon URL / File
https://example.com/icon.png

Wormholes

Name	Type	Galaxy	Created	Actions
Beach	DESC		11 10:46	
Sea L	DESC		11 10:46	
Pacifi	DESC		11 10:46	
Yellow	ACC		11 10:46	
Beach	DESC		11 10:46	
Sea R	DESC		11 10:46	
Coast	DESC		11 10:46	
Wild C	DESC		11 10:46	
Beach	DESC		11 10:46	

Logout

Steps:

1. Open **New Wormhole** from the editor home (or open an existing wormhole's edit modal and change its type).
2. Set **Wormhole type** to **Portal**. A **Target Galaxy** field appears, with a dropdown listing every galaxy you have access to.
3. Pick the destination galaxy from the dropdown. The button next to it, **Create New Galaxy**, is a shortcut for the case where the destination does not exist yet; selecting it lets you author the destination inline. Most of the time, you pick an existing galaxy.
4. **Name** the portal something readable. A portal is a wormhole, so the name appears in lists and in the 3D scene; choose a name that signals the journey, not just the destination. *To the tide pools* reads better than *Tide pools*.
5. Add a **Description** if you want a short paragraph to appear when the visitor opens the portal's info card. The description is shown briefly before the journey to the destination galaxy begins; treat it as a threshold sentence.
6. Optional: assign a few **keywords**. Portals can carry keywords like any other wormhole; this helps the portal surface in keyword-based discovery.
7. Save.

The portal now appears in the wormhole list with a **Portal** tag in the Type column, and as a distinguishable node in the 3D scene.

What visitors experience

A visitor who clicks a portal in the 3D scene sees:

- The portal's info card opens, just like any other wormhole.
- The card shows the portal's name, the description, and (depending on the instance's settings) a **Travel** or similarly named call-to-action button.
- Activating the call-to-action closes the current galaxy and loads the destination.
- In the destination galaxy, the visitor arrives at the galaxy's entrance (the default starting position), not at a specific wormhole.

The visitor can use the browser's Back button to return to the origin galaxy. Telaris does **not** automatically place a return portal in the destination galaxy; if you want the journey to be round-trip, you need to place a matching portal manually.

Round-trip portals

When you place a portal from A to B, consider whether you also want a portal from B back to A. The two are independent: each is a wormhole in its own galaxy. There is no "linked portals" concept.

The decision is editorial:

- **Yes, place a return portal** when the two galaxies are equal partners in a conversation; visitors arriving in B should be invited back to A as naturally as they were invited from A to B.
- **No, leave the return implicit** when the visitor's natural path is one-way (A is the framing galaxy; B is the answer; the visitor returns through the browser, if at all).

If you place a return portal, name it for the destination it leads to, not for "going back." *To the coastal plants* reads better than *Back* or *Return*.

Portals and the keyword canvas

A portal's keyword chips appear on the keyword canvas like any other wormhole's. A portal tagged *intertidal* contributes to the *intertidal* connection web. Sometimes editors tag portals with a specific keyword like *portal* so they can be filtered out of keyword-driven discovery (some visitors may not want portal-heavy hops); in our demo galaxy, the portal wormhole carries the tag *portal* for exactly that reason.

Things worth knowing

- **A portal can only target one galaxy at a time.** If you want a "hub" that fans out to many galaxies, the answer is many portals, not one. You can place several portals in a single galaxy, each pointing somewhere different.
- **The target dropdown lists only galaxies you can edit.** If the galaxy you want to portal to is on another instance, that is federation territory and is the operator's domain; the editor surface does not author cross-instance portals.
- **A portal can be retargeted** by editing it and choosing a different galaxy in the Target Galaxy field. Visitors who had bookmarked the portal will continue to land on whichever galaxy is now selected. Plan for that when changing destinations after publication.
- **A portal targeting its own galaxy** is technically allowed but functionally pointless: the visitor lands back where they came from. The editor UI will not stop you, but the result is a no-op.
- **Deleting a portal removes the wormhole entirely.** The destination galaxy is unaffected; only the connection is gone. The destination's own portals (if any) still work.
- **Portals carry no media.** They have a name, a description, and keywords, plus the target galaxy. The image, video, audio, and PDF fields are still in the modal but should be left empty for portals; if you fill them, they are simply ignored by the portal's visitor experience.

Visitor views

The editor's work is read by visitors. Almost every editorial choice you make eventually shows up on the visitor side, either directly (the description, the media, the keywords) or indirectly (the relationships drawn on the keyword canvas, the way wormholes are tagged). This chapter is your map of what visitors see, and the editor-side switches that shape it.

The visitor view is reached by following any visitor URL of your instance: typically the galaxy slug, sometimes with no slug at all (your operator can confirm the entry path).



The 3D scene

The default visitor view is a three-dimensional scene where each wormhole is a small object floating in space against the galaxy's chosen theme background. The visitor's mouse rotates the view; scrolling or pinching zooms; clicking on a wormhole opens its info card.

What you choose as an editor that shows here:

- **The galaxy's theme** (chapter 4) controls the look: which icons render the wormholes, what the background looks like, what the lighting feels like.

- **The Use-as-wormhole-icon toggle** on each wormhole (chapter 5) decides whether that wormhole renders as its image (when on) or as the theme's default icon (when off).
- **The Accentuate flag** on a wormhole renders it larger and more prominent in the scene.
- **The Show Keywords flag** prints the wormhole's keywords as floating labels next to the icon.

These four choices interact: a galaxy of Accentuated, image-iconified, keyword-displaying wormholes is a busy scene; a galaxy of theme-iconified, plain wormholes is a quiet one. There is no "right" mode; pick the visual register that matches the content's editorial register.

The info card

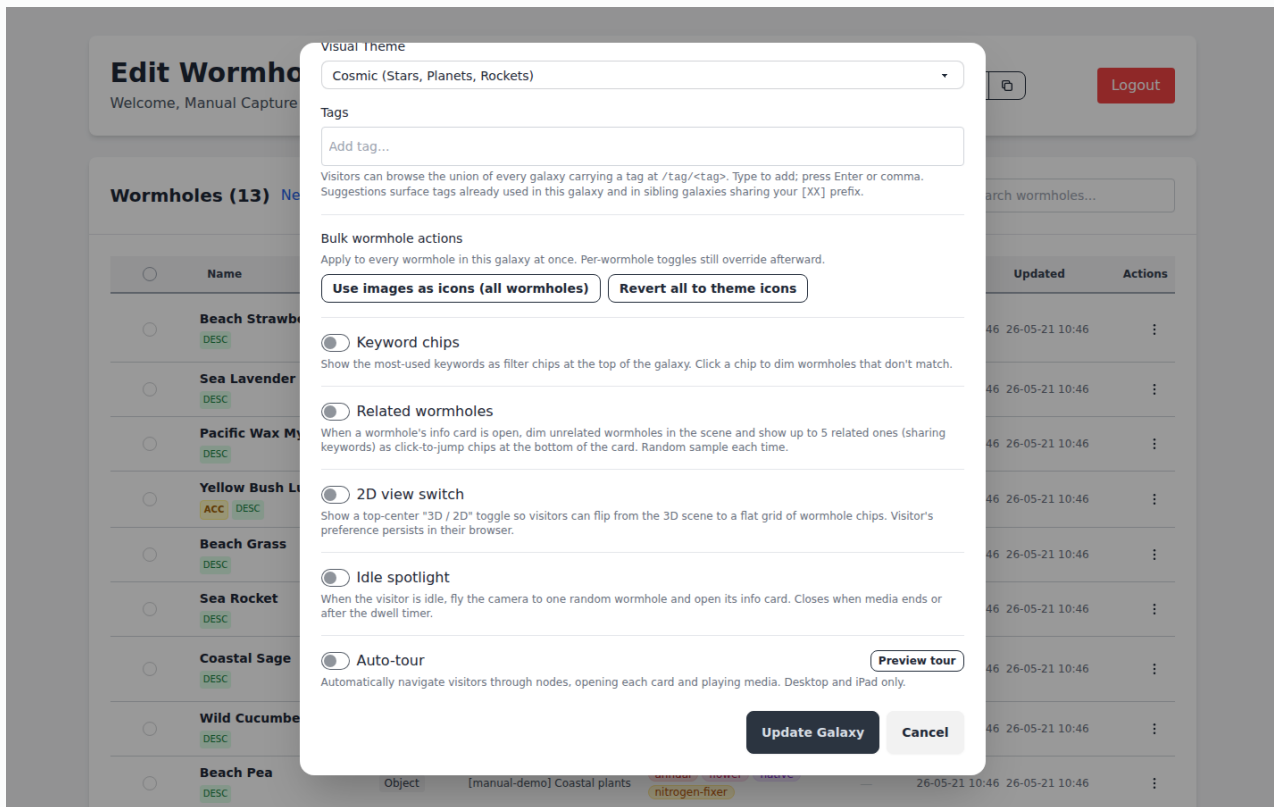
A visitor who clicks a wormhole sees its **info card** open over the scene. The card contains, in order:

- The wormhole's **name** at the top.
- The **primary visual** (image, video, or PDF) below the name, sized to the card.
- The **description** as a body paragraph.
- The **audio player** if audio is attached.
- The **embed code** if one was supplied.
- A row of **keyword chips** at the bottom of the card, each clickable.
- The **Open Link** button if the wormhole carries a URL.

When the visitor clicks a keyword chip on the info card, the scene dims wormholes that do not carry that keyword. The card closes. This is one of the main ways visitors navigate by tags rather than by name.

The Discovery toggles

The galaxy settings modal carries a Discovery section (chapter 4 introduced the modal; here is what each toggle does on the visitor side):



Each toggle is off by default. Turn one on when you want the corresponding feature.

Auto-tour

A self-running tour through the galaxy. When on, additional options appear:

- **Start mode** (manual, idle, immediate):
 - **Manual:** the visitor must press a Play button to start the tour.
 - **Idle:** the tour starts automatically after the visitor has not interacted with the scene for a number of seconds (configurable).
 - **Immediate:** the tour starts as soon as the visitor lands on the galaxy.
- **Node selection** (all, accentuated, random N, tagged keywords):
 - **All:** the tour visits every wormhole in the galaxy in order.
 - **Accentuated only:** visits only wormholes flagged Accentuated.
 - **Random N:** picks N wormholes at random each session; the number is configurable.
 - **Tagged keywords:** visits only wormholes carrying one of a chosen set of keywords. The list of keywords is set in a sub-field that appears when this option is selected.
- **Dwell time** in seconds at each stop, before the tour moves to the next.
- **Loop:** when on, the tour cycles back to the beginning after the final stop; when off, it ends quietly.

A **Preview tour** button appears next to the Auto-tour fields; selecting it opens the visitor view in a new tab with the tour running, so you can check the timing without saving the configuration.

Chapter 11 walks through tours in more depth.

Idle spotlight

When on, the scene gently spotlights a different wormhole every N seconds when the visitor is idle. Unlike auto-tour, it does not move the camera or open info cards; it just brings one wormhole forward, softly, like a museum changing the room lighting.

Two settings:

- **Idle threshold** in seconds before the spotlight begins.
- **Selection** (all, accentuated only).

Idle spotlight is well-suited to ambient-feeling galaxies (a poem cycle; a sequence of photographs); it gives the room something to do when the visitor has stopped clicking.

Keyword chips

When on, the scene paints a strip of pastel chips at the bottom of the visitor's screen, one chip per most-used keyword in the galaxy. Visitors can click a chip to dim every wormhole that does not carry it.

Use when the galaxy has a strong keyword vocabulary that visitors would naturally browse by; turn off when keywords are too granular or too numerous for chips to be useful.

Related wormholes

When on, an info card opens with up to five **related** wormhole chips at the bottom: other wormholes (in this or sibling galaxies) that share at least one keyword with the open one. The visitor can click a chip to jump directly to the related wormhole.

This is the main way visitors travel laterally through a network without opening a portal. Turn it on when you want the visitor to discover the web; turn it off when you want the visitor to stay focused on one wormhole at a time.

2D view

When on, a small **3D / 2D** toggle appears at the top of the visitor's screen. Switching to 2D collapses the scene into a flat grid of wormhole chips: each chip is the wormhole's icon plus name, arranged in rows. The 2D view is faster

to load and easier to scan; some visitors prefer it for finding a specific wormhole quickly.

The visitor's choice between 3D and 2D persists in their browser (you do not have to keep choosing).

Provenance footers and attribution

When a wormhole's editorial provenance carries an attribution (`Image attribution`, source-community credit, or a federated mirror notice), the info card shows it as a small footer line below the description.

There is no global toggle to hide provenance footers; if your work credits a photographer or a source community, that credit appears whenever the wormhole is opened. Author attribution and source-community consent are first-class editorial concerns; chapter 13 covers the editorial discipline around them.

Things worth knowing

- **The visitor sees what you have published, not your draft.** There is no "preview" mode separate from the published view; once you save a wormhole or a galaxy setting, the visitor's next page load reflects the change. To preview a change without affecting visitors, you would need to make the change in a galaxy that is not yet public.
- **The 3D scene runs in the visitor's browser.** Older devices or low-power computers may struggle with very dense galaxies. The 2D view toggle is the standard remedy.
- **Audio that autoplays may be blocked by the visitor's browser.** Most browsers do not allow audio to start without the visitor's interaction. If you turn on Autoplay (chapter 6) and a visitor reports no sound, this is the most likely cause; the visitor's first click on the page usually un-blocks the audio.
- **The Discovery toggles are independent of each other.** Auto-tour and idle spotlight can both be on at the same time (the spotlight kicks in if the tour ends or is not started). Pick the combinations that fit your editorial intent; the toggles do not gate each other.

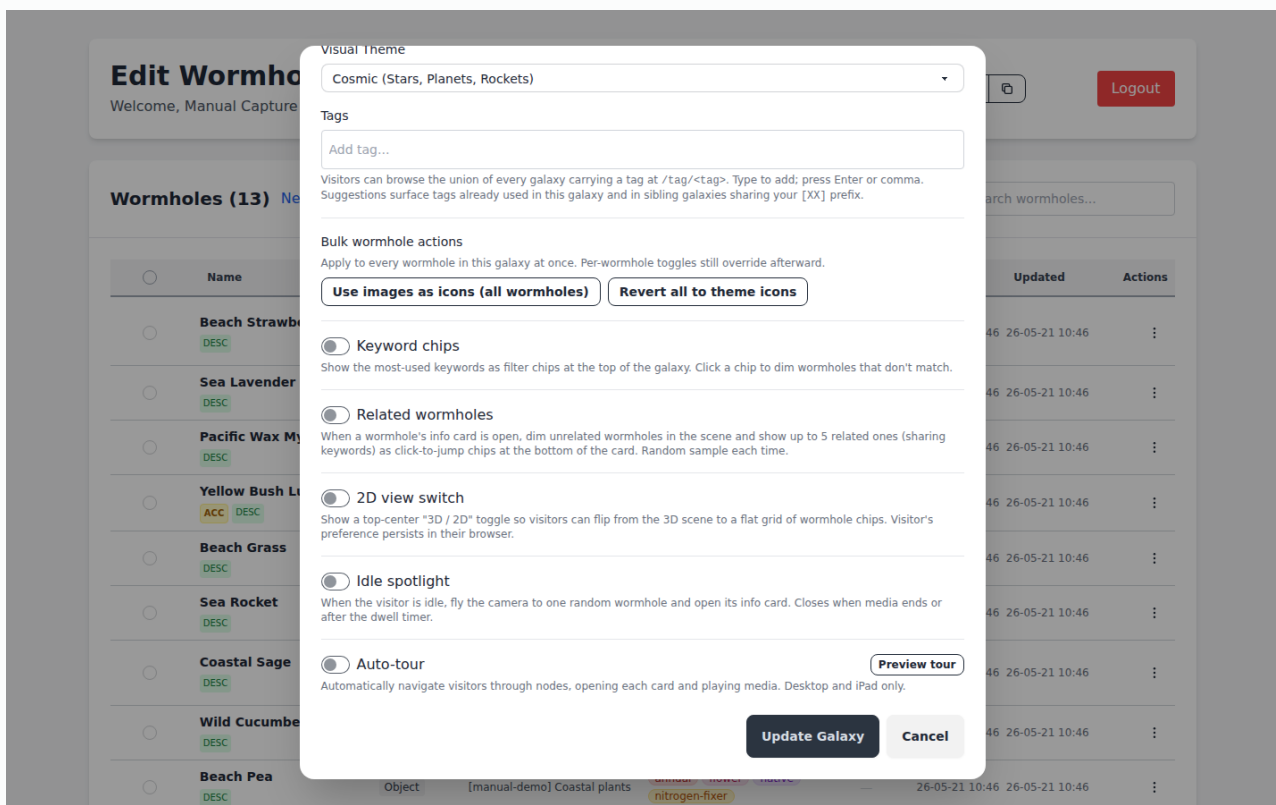
Tours

A tour is a curated path through a galaxy. The editor picks the start, picks the order, sets a dwell time at each stop, and decides whether the tour loops or ends. Visitors can start the tour themselves by pressing Play; or the tour can run on its own when the visitor has been idle; or the tour can begin the instant the visitor lands on the galaxy. This chapter walks through each path of authoring a tour and the practical considerations.

A tour is a **configuration of a galaxy**, not a separate object. Turning on the tour configures the existing wormholes to be visited in a chosen order; turning it off leaves the wormholes untouched. A galaxy can carry one tour configuration at a time; if you want two tours, you publish a copy of the galaxy with the second tour.

Where you author it

A tour lives inside the **Galaxy settings** modal, in the Discovery section (chapter 4 introduces the modal; chapter 10 introduces the Discovery toggles).



The Discovery section's first toggle is **Auto-tour**. Switching it on reveals the tour configuration fields:

- Start mode.

- Node selection.
- Dwell time at each stop.
- Loop on / off.

Below these is a **Preview tour** button.

Start mode

Choose how the tour begins:

- **Manual:** a small **Play** button appears in the lower-right corner of the visitor's 3D scene. The tour begins when the visitor presses it. Use when the tour is an *offered* path, not a default one.
- **Idle:** the tour begins automatically after the visitor has been inactive for a configurable number of seconds. The idle threshold field appears below this option. Use when the galaxy is meant to be encountered both interactively (the visitor explores) and ambiently (the gallery wakes up when nobody touches it).
- **Immediate:** the tour starts the instant the visitor lands on the galaxy. The visitor can stop the tour at any time with the in-scene controls. Use for galleries whose intended experience is the tour itself; the editor's path is the canonical reading.

There is no right answer; each option suits a different editorial intention. Most authored galaxies start with **Manual** and graduate to **Idle** or **Immediate** as the editor finds a path worth defaulting to.

Node selection

Choose which wormholes the tour visits, and in what order:

- **All:** every wormhole in the galaxy, in the order they were created. The simplest selection; useful for short galaxies where every wormhole carries equal weight.
- **Accentuated only:** only wormholes flagged Accentuated. Use when you want some wormholes to be on the tour and others to remain reachable but not foregrounded. The Accentuated flag is set per wormhole (chapter 5).
- **Random N:** picks N wormholes at random each session. A field appears for N. Use for galleries that should feel fresh on revisit; the visitor sees a different slice each time.
- **Tagged keywords:** visits only wormholes carrying one of a chosen set of keywords. A keyword picker appears, similar to the keyword chip input on a

wormhole modal. Use when you want a *thematic* tour (only wormholes tagged *medicinal*; only ones tagged *native*).

For tagged-keyword tours, the order in which wormholes are visited is the order in which they were created, filtered to the keyword set. There is no manual ordering field; if you need a strictly authored sequence, the order in which you create the wormholes is the order the tour will respect.

Dwell time

A single number, in seconds, controlling how long the tour pauses at each wormhole before moving on. The dwell starts when the wormhole's info card opens; the next wormhole is selected when the dwell elapses.

A useful default is five to eight seconds; this is long enough for a visitor to read a short description and look at the image, short enough to keep momentum across a long tour. Wormholes with audio attached often deserve a longer dwell so the audio can resolve before the tour moves on; chapter 6 covers audio loop semantics.

The dwell is global to the tour; the editor cannot (yet) set a different dwell per wormhole.

Loop

A single toggle:

- **On:** after the final wormhole, the tour returns to the first and continues. Use for ambient gallery installations where the visitor may wander in mid-cycle.
- **Off:** the tour ends quietly after the final wormhole; the scene returns to interactive mode and the visitor can explore freely. Use for narrative tours with a beginning and an end.

Previewing a tour

Below the tour configuration fields, a **Preview tour** button appears. Selecting it opens the visitor view in a new tab with the tour running, regardless of whether you have saved the configuration. This is the right way to check timing, ordering, and dwell before publishing changes to visitors.

The preview reflects whatever you have entered in the modal, not what is currently saved. If you decide the preview is wrong, change the fields and select Preview again; the new tab updates.

Tours and Accentuate

The Accentuate flag on a wormhole (chapter 5) overlaps with tour selection but is not the same thing. Accentuated wormholes are *visually larger* in the 3D scene regardless of whether a tour visits them. The **Accentuated only** node-selection option for the tour is one way to use the flag, but you can also Accentuate wormholes that are not in the tour and have a tour that includes wormholes that are not Accentuated.

The pattern that reads cleanest:

- Use Accentuate for wormholes that should stand out visually at all times.
- Use the tour to specify the *narrative path*, which may or may not overlap with the visual emphasis.

Tours and the keyword canvas

A keyword-tagged tour (node selection set to *tagged keywords*) gives the editor a path through the galaxy that follows the keyword vocabulary the canvas authors. The two surfaces work together: choose the keywords the tour will follow on the canvas first, draw the relationships between them, then choose the tour to follow that thematic path on the visitor side.

The connection is editorial rather than structural; Telaris does not require the canvas to be populated before configuring a tour, but the resulting tour often feels more deliberate when the keyword vocabulary has been worked through.

Things worth knowing

- **Auto-tour does not pause for audio.** If a wormhole has a 30-second audio track and the dwell is 8 seconds, the tour moves on at 8 seconds while the audio keeps playing in the background. To let the audio complete, lengthen the dwell.
- **The visitor can always stop the tour.** A Stop or Pause control appears during a running tour; the visitor can also click anywhere outside the info card to interrupt. Tours should feel offered, not forced.
- **Random-N tours change every session.** A visitor revisiting the page does not see the same N wormholes; the random selection re-rolls. Helpful for ambient feel; surprising if you expected a stable sequence.
- **Tagged-keyword tours follow the union of the chosen keywords.** A tour set to keywords *native* and *edible* visits every wormhole tagged with **either** *native* or *edible* (or both); it does not require both.
- **Tours are scoped to the current galaxy.** A tour cannot visit wormholes in another galaxy; for cross-galaxy paths, use portals (chapter 9).

- **The 2D view (chapter 10) interacts with tours gracefully.** A visitor in 2D mode sees the tour as a sequence of highlighted chips, not as camera motion. The dwell still applies; the visual is just flatter.

Multigalaxy work

Sometimes an idea lives across more than one galaxy: a research topic that spans two collections; an exhibit with several rooms; a series of related issues. Telaris is built so the wormhole stays in its home galaxy and the *combination* is a viewing arrangement, not a structural one. This chapter walks through the three ways you can compose galaxies, and when each is the right choice.

The three composition paths

Telaris offers three ways to put multiple galaxies in a single view:

1. **Galaxy tags** (chapter 4): two galaxies that share a tag form a *galaxy union*. Visitors arrive at the union via `/tag/<tag-slug>` and see wormholes from every tagged galaxy together, with each wormhole keeping the visual style of its source galaxy.
2. **Bracket prefix grouping**: galaxies whose names start with the same `[bracket]` prefix automatically union at `/[bracket]`. A natural fallback to galaxy tags; the prefix is also the visual signal for editors browsing the picker.
3. **Explicit galaxy lists**: passing a comma-separated list in the URL `?galaxies=slug1,slug2` produces a one-off union. Useful for sharing a curated combination without changing the underlying galaxies.

The choice between the three depends on **how lasting the combination is**:

- *Lasting*: galaxy tags. The connection is editorial and persists across sessions.
- *Conventional*: bracket prefix. Useful when the galaxies are siblings by naming convention, not just by tag.
- *Ad-hoc*: explicit list. Useful for an email or a link that walks a reader through a specific combination once.

Sharing wormholes without duplicating

The first instinct in many archive systems is to copy a wormhole into a second galaxy when an idea belongs in both places. Telaris is built against this instinct: copying creates two wormholes to maintain, two places to update when the source changes, two places to retract from when the source community withdraws consent.

The intended path is: leave the wormhole in its single home galaxy and let **shared keywords** connect it to others. Visitors who follow *intertidal* in galaxy A

reach the *intertidal*-tagged wormholes in galaxy B; the wormhole's content lives in one place; the connection is computed from the keyword.

When that is not enough, the editor's options are, in order of how invasive each is:

1. **Add a galaxy tag** to both galaxies that share the theme. Visitors who follow the tag see the union.
2. **Place a portal** (chapter 9) from one galaxy to the other. The portal is a wormhole, but it is a small, deliberate one; it does not duplicate any content.
3. **Duplicate the wormhole** (chapter 5's actions menu). Only when the wormhole's content genuinely needs to live in two places (e.g., a galaxy is being seeded with material from another, with the editorial decision to lift rather than link). The duplicate is independent from then on; both copies need to be maintained.

The first two of these are almost always preferable to the third.

The visitor experience of a union

A visitor who arrives at a galaxy-tag union (e.g., `/tag/coast`) sees:

- A scene composed of the wormholes of every galaxy carrying the tag.
- **Per-wormhole origin themes:** each wormhole renders with its source galaxy's theme, not a single unified theme. This is intentional; the visitor sees the union as the *meeting of galaxies*, not as a flattening of them.
- A galaxy strip or picker at the top showing the constituent galaxies, with the option to switch into a single one.
- The same Discovery features as any galaxy (keyword chips, related wormholes, etc.), now drawing from the union.

The visitor's URL bar stays at `/tag/<tag>` while they are in the union; clicking on a wormhole opens its info card without leaving the union.

When to add a galaxy tag

A tag is editorial. The two questions to ask:

- **Is the relationship between these galaxies long-lived?** A tag persists; if the relationship is one-off, an explicit URL is cleaner.
- **Is the relationship symmetric?** A tag is symmetric (every galaxy carrying the tag is equally a member). If the relationship is directional (galaxy A is the introduction to galaxy B), a portal is more honest.

Examples that justify a tag:

- A series of related research collections.
- An exhibit with multiple rooms.
- A regional grouping (galaxies that all describe content from a single landscape, geography, or community).

Examples that do not:

- "Old galaxies I want to bundle for a one-time link" (use `?galaxies=...`).
- "Galaxies that share a few keywords" (use the keywords directly).

When to use bracket prefix grouping

Telaris recognises galaxy names beginning with the same `[bracket]` as a family. A galaxy named `[demo] Coastal plants` and another named `[demo] Tide pools` share the prefix `[demo]`; visitors who follow `/[demo]` see both in union.

The bracket prefix is most useful when:

- You have several editors working on related galaxies, and the prefix signals to them that the galaxies are siblings.
- The galaxies form a family that you also want visible-as-a-family in the editor picker (the picker groups galaxies by bracket prefix).
- You want union behaviour without explicitly authoring a tag on each galaxy.

The bracket prefix and an explicit galaxy tag are not mutually exclusive; both apply if both are present.

When to use an explicit galaxy list

Sometimes you want a one-off union for a specific moment: an email to a curator showing them a particular combination; a teaching link that walks a class through three galaxies side by side; a temporary exhibit that does not warrant a long-lived tag.

The URL form is `?galaxies=slug1,slug2,slug3` appended to your instance's address. The result is identical to a tag union, but the combination exists only as the URL itself.

This is the right tool for ad-hoc curation. It also serves as a quick sanity-check: if a particular combination of galaxies reads well as an explicit URL, you have a candidate for a permanent tag.

Cross-instance multigalaxy

What about galaxies that live on **other** Telaris instances? That belongs to the operator's domain: cross-instance content arrives in your editor surface via federation or bridge imports the operator configures. From the editor's seat, federated and bridged galaxies behave like local galaxies (a galaxy is a galaxy is a galaxy), but the editor cannot author cross-instance unions; only the operator can set up the federation that makes them possible.

Things worth knowing

- **A wormhole belongs to exactly one galaxy at a time.** Multigalaxy is a *viewing* concept, not a structural one. The wormhole's home galaxy is its single source of truth.
- **The visitor in a union view cannot tell which galaxy authored a given wormhole at first glance** beyond the visual theme of the wormhole's icon. The info card shows the source galaxy in the footer; the icon's theme is the at-a-glance indicator.
- **A galaxy in a union does not lose its individuality.** Visitors can click into a single galaxy from within the union view; the union is a viewing layer, not a merge.
- **Keywords are global by text** (chapter 7). The keywords on a wormhole in galaxy A are the same keywords as the same words on a wormhole in galaxy B. A union view consolidates the keyword chip strip across all constituent galaxies; clicking a keyword in the union filters the union.
- **The keyword canvas is still per-galaxy** (chapter 8). There is no "union canvas"; each galaxy holds its own keyword arrangement. The keywords themselves are shared (renaming or merging applies everywhere), but the chip layout and the drawn relations are scoped to each galaxy.

Editorial sovereignty

This is the chapter most software manuals skip. Telaris's structure – no folders, no review queue, no central vocabulary, no "wrong" tag – only works if editors hold the position with intention. The choices you make are sovereign. They are not validated by anyone else. They are not run through an approval flow. They are not silently corrected by an algorithm. The decision to apply a keyword is yours; the decision to leave one off is also yours.

This chapter is about what that means in practice.

What sovereignty does and does not include

Editorial sovereignty in Telaris means:

- You decide what goes into a galaxy and what stays out.
- You decide which keywords to apply and which to omit.
- You decide which connections (on the keyword canvas) belong and which do not.
- You decide which wormholes to accentuate and which to leave plain.
- You decide when to retire a wormhole and when to keep it.

It does **not** mean:

- You can edit other editors' galaxies. Each galaxy has an owning editor (or set of editors) assigned by the operator; you can only act inside galaxies you have been assigned to.
- You can override a source community's withdrawal of consent. If material in your galaxy was contributed by a community and they withdraw it, the answer is to remove the material, not to argue.
- You can publish without restraint. Your operator runs the instance and is responsible for what visitors see; if the operator asks you to remove something for a reason that crosses your editorial line, that is a conversation between you and the operator, not a feature in the software.

The line is the line; the software does not police it; the responsibility lives with the editor.

When *not* to apply a keyword

The instinct of many archive systems is to tag everything. Telaris's design rewards the opposite: a keyword applied carelessly does worse than no keyword. Every keyword you attach is a connection to every other wormhole carrying the same word; if the connection is not meaningful, the visitor's path gets noisier.

Practical refusals:

- Refuse a keyword that names the obvious. *Plant* in a plant galaxy. *Coast* on a coastal-plant wormhole. These carry no signal because every wormhole nearby would share them.
- Refuse a keyword that is wrong in a way nobody else will notice. If a wormhole is *technically* native but the source community describes it as *introduced for centuries*, the editorial truth is more useful than the botanical one. Apply *introduced* (or both); the keyword strip is your editorial sentence.
- Refuse a keyword that puts a wormhole in a category it should not stand for. A wormhole about a community's ceremonial plant should not necessarily be tagged *edible* even when it is also eaten; the editorial frame may be ceremonial first, food incidentally.

The fewer keywords you assign, the more deliberate each connection feels. Five precise tags read better than fifteen comprehensive ones.

When *not* to draw a connection

The keyword canvas (chapter 8) lets you draw lines between any two keywords. The discipline is to draw only the lines that say something the visitor would not infer from the keywords themselves.

- Refuse a connection between two keywords that obviously co-occur. *Native* and *perennial* both appear on many plants; if the editorial point is just "these often go together," the connection adds noise.
- Refuse a connection whose note you cannot write. If you cannot write a one-sentence note explaining why two keywords belong, the connection is decorative; leave it out.
- Refuse a connection that contradicts your editorial frame. Two keywords that *technically* relate but that the galaxy's framing treats as distinct should stay disconnected; the absence of a line is also an editorial choice.

The canvas reads best when it has fewer, sharper lines than it has chips.

Withdrawal of consent

Some Telaris content originates with source communities (a community that contributed photographs, a culture that hosts the practice you are documenting, an interview subject whose words you are republishing). The consent of the source community is the editorial floor, not a feature you can turn off.

When a source community withdraws consent:

- Remove the wormhole. Do not argue, do not negotiate, do not delay.
- If the material informed other wormholes (the wormhole was the source of a keyword, of a connection drawn on the canvas), follow the implications: a keyword that no longer maps to anything is a keyword to remove; a connection that no longer connects anything is one to delete.
- Tell your operator. The operator may need to clear the material from snapshots or from federated mirrors; that is their work, not yours, but they need the signal.

The platform does not have an "editorial review" that overrides community consent. Withdrawal is final.

When *not* to publish a wormhole at all

A wormhole can be drafted, then never published. The simplest way: keep it in a galaxy whose visibility is restricted (your operator can configure this; some instances have "draft" galaxies that visitors do not see). The pattern that reads well:

- Draft galaxies for in-progress work.
- Public galaxies for material you are willing to stand by.
- Move wormholes from draft to public when the editorial decision is firm.

If your instance does not have a draft-galaxy pattern, ask your operator about setting one up; the difference between *drafting* and *publishing* is a real editorial distinction, and the software should support it.

There is no review queue

Telaris does not have an approval flow. There is no "Submit for review" button, no editor-in-chief, no central pair of eyes that decides what is good enough. The decision to publish lives in the moment you save the wormhole.

This is by design. A review queue would import the assumption that one editor's judgement needs another's approval, which is the platform pattern Telaris is built to refuse. The cost is responsibility: when you save, you publish.

Two practices that hold up:

- **Read the wormhole as a visitor before saving.** The View button in the actions menu opens the wormhole's info card in read-only mode; this is the moment to catch a tag you would not stand by, a description that is sharper than you meant, a keyword that connects somewhere you did not intend.

- **Conversation with other editors, where they exist.** Telaris does not formalise it, but the conversations between editors of related galaxies are how a network keeps its editorial coherence. If your instance has more than one editor, find a rhythm for talking about the choices; the software does not, and will not.

Things worth knowing

- **There is no "edit history" surface for visitors.** Visitors see what is currently published; they do not see the history of a wormhole's edits. If a change is editorial (a tag added, a description revised, a media file replaced), it lands silently; if you want visitors to know the work has been revised, write it in the description.
- **A wormhole's editor can change.** Your operator can re-assign galaxies; a galaxy you authored last month may be edited by someone else next month. Treat your editorial choices as durable to that succession: leave the galaxy in a state another editor can pick up.
- **Editorial sovereignty does not extend to the operator's domain.** Federation decisions, peer admission, snapshot scheduling, key rotation, and any other operational choice belong to the operator. Editors are not consulted on them; nor are operators consulted on editorial choices. The line is firm.
- **Telaris's voice is observational, not promotional.** The brand book describes the voice in detail; for editors, the practical takeaway is that the platform does not write your descriptions, does not sweeten your phrasing, does not soften your refusal. Your prose is your prose. The platform frames it; the framing does not edit it.

Troubleshooting

The everyday situations an editor runs into, what to try, and when to ask your operator. This chapter is organised by the symptom, not by the cause; look for what *you* see, not for what is *technically* happening.

I cannot log in

What you see: the login form refuses your credentials, or you reach the login page when you expected to be already signed in.

What to try, in order:

1. Confirm the email address and password are correct. Both are case-sensitive.
2. Use the **Forgot your password?** link below the Sign In button. An email with a reset link arrives within a minute.
3. Check that you are on your instance's address. If your operator runs multiple instances, your login is scoped to one.

When to ask your operator: if the password reset link does not arrive (check spam first), if your reset email is bounced back, or if you are sure your password is correct and the form still refuses.

A wormhole I created vanished

What you see: a wormhole you authored is no longer in the wormhole list.

What to try:

1. Confirm the **Current Galaxy** dropdown is on the right galaxy (or set to *All my galaxies*). The wormhole may be in a different galaxy than you expect, especially if you used the Galaxy dropdown inside the wormhole modal.
2. Use the search box on the editor home. Search for the wormhole's name; if it exists in any galaxy you can edit, search finds it.
3. Check the **Touched today** filter; if you accidentally clicked it, only today's edits show.

When to ask your operator: if search across All my galaxies returns nothing and you are certain you saved the wormhole. The wormhole may have been deleted (by you, or by another editor); your operator may be able to restore from a snapshot.

I cannot edit a wormhole; the modal opens in viewer mode

What you see: clicking a wormhole row opens an info card or a read-only preview, not the edit modal.

What you might be seeing:

- The wormhole is in a galaxy you have **read access** to but not edit access to (some instances allow editors to see all galaxies but only edit some). The wormhole is editable by another editor.
- The wormhole was **imported** from an external source (a sister archive, a bridged community). Imported wormholes are read-only by design; changes must happen at the source.

When to ask your operator: if the wormhole was authored on this instance and you should have edit rights but the modal still opens read-only.

An upload fails

What you see: the file picker accepts the file, the upload begins, then an error appears or the modal closes without the file attached.

What to try:

1. Check the file size. PDFs are commonly capped at 25 MB (your operator may have set a different cap); images and videos may have their own limits.
2. Check the file type. Telaris supports JPG and PNG (and most other common formats) for images; MP4 for video; MP3, OGG, and WAV for audio; PDF for documents. Files of other types are rejected at upload time.
3. Try a smaller file or a different format. If the original is too large, compress or transcode before uploading.

When to ask your operator: if uploads consistently fail for files within the stated limits, or if you need the limit raised.

A keyword's chip is in the wrong place on the canvas

What you see: a chip on the keyword canvas is overlapping another chip, sitting outside the visible area, or floating in a position that does not match where you remember placing it.

What to try:

1. Drag the chip to where you want it; the new position saves automatically.
2. If many chips are arranged badly, use the **Reset all chip positions** option in the canvas help overlay (the ? at the top of the canvas).

3. Refresh the page; the canvas re-fetches the latest layout.

When to ask your operator: rarely. The canvas is forgiving; almost every problem is solved by dragging.

A change I made does not appear in the visitor view

What you see: you saved a change in the editor, but a visitor (or you in another tab) does not see it.

What to try:

1. Refresh the visitor tab. Telaris does not push live updates; the change is on the next page load.
2. Check that you saved with **Save**, not closed the modal with **Cancel** or by clicking outside.
3. Check that you are looking at the same galaxy. The visitor tab may be on a different galaxy than the one you edited.

When to ask your operator: if you saved and refreshed and the change is still not visible after a minute. Edge caches may take a brief moment to invalidate; if it persists, that is operator territory.

A button is greyed out

What you see: a button in the editor home or in a modal is visible but not clickable.

What you might be seeing:

- The button is **conditional on something you have not done yet**. For instance, the Settings button next to the galaxy picker only enables when a specific galaxy is selected (not *All my galaxies*).
- The button is **gated by your role**. If you are an editor and the action is admin-only, the button may appear but stay disabled.

When to ask your operator: if you believe you should have access to the action and the button is still disabled. Your role may need adjusting.

My session expired in the middle of editing

What you see: a save fails with an "unauthenticated" or "please log in" message; the editor returns you to the login page.

What to try:

1. Log back in. Your session expires periodically; this is normal.

2. If you were editing a wormhole when the session expired and the change was not saved, you may have lost work since the last save. The text in the modal is sometimes recoverable from the browser's form-restore behaviour; if not, the wormhole reverts to its last saved state.

When to ask your operator: if sessions expire unusually quickly. The default session lasts 30 days with activity renewal; if you are kicked out within minutes, something is off.

A message I sent to another editor seems lost

What you see: you sent an in-app message to another editor (or to an instance operator) and the recipient has not replied, or you cannot find the sent message.

What you might be seeing:

- The recipient has not opened the inbox yet.
- The in-app messaging surface may live in a section of the admin UI that you do not have access to. Most editor-to-editor communication is best handled outside Telaris (email, Signal, whatever your operator and your team have agreed on).

When to ask your operator: if in-app messaging is the canonical channel on your instance and a message you sent through it does not arrive at the recipient.

A wormhole opens to a blank info card

What you see: clicking a wormhole opens the info card but no description, no media, no keywords.

What to try:

1. Check that the wormhole you opened is the one you meant to author content for. Empty wormholes are allowed; they just have no body.
2. Open the wormhole in the editor and confirm the Description field has the text you expect.
3. If the description appears in the editor but not in the visitor view, refresh both browser tabs.

When to ask your operator: if the wormhole has content in the editor but is blank in the visitor view after refresh.

The 3D scene is slow or stuttering

What you see: the visitor 3D scene takes a long time to load, animates jerkily, or freezes briefly.

What you might be seeing:

- A dense galaxy on an older device. The 3D scene runs in the visitor's browser; very dense galaxies are demanding on lower-power hardware.
- A galaxy with many image-iconified wormholes (each image renders into the scene as a texture).

What to try:

- Suggest the visitor toggle to the **2D view** (chapter 10) if that is enabled on the galaxy.
- For galaxies you author, consider whether all the image-as-icon flags are necessary; a galaxy with twelve image-iconified wormholes is faster than one with fifty.

When to ask your operator: if the slowness is universal (every visitor sees it) and not specific to one device.

I do not know who runs this instance

What you see: this manual keeps telling you to "ask your operator." If you do not know who that is, you need to.

What to try:

- Check your instance's address. Many instances have a contact page at `/contact` or a governance page at `/governance` that names the operator.
- Look at the original email that invited you to be an editor. The sender is most often the operator.
- If nothing else, the next editor or visitor you talk to about Telaris is likely to know.

If you cannot identify the operator at all, that is itself a kind of problem worth solving; an instance without a reachable operator is one that drifts.

Glossary

Every named concept in the editor manual, in one place. Dictionary-style; each entry tells you what the term means and which chapter walks through it.

Accentuate. A per-wormhole flag (chapter 5) that makes the wormhole render larger and more prominent in the 3D scene. Often paired with auto-tour for narrative emphasis.

Audio. A media type a wormhole can carry, independent of the primary visual. Optional autoplay and loop toggles. Chapter 6.

Auto-tour. A self-running tour through a galaxy (chapter 11), configured in the galaxy settings Discovery section. Modes: manual, idle, immediate.

Bracket prefix. A naming convention (e.g., `[exhibit] Room A`) that groups galaxies into a visible family in the picker and a `/[exhibit]` union URL. Chapter 12.

Bulk by keyword. A modal (chapter 7) that operates on every wormhole in the current galaxy carrying a chosen keyword: delete them in bulk, or move them in bulk to another galaxy.

Canvas. Short for the keyword canvas (chapter 8). The drawing surface where editors lay out keyword chips and draw relationships between them.

Chip. The pastel pill that represents a keyword in the editor UI. Each keyword has a deterministic colour by text; the colour is the same everywhere on the instance.

Cluster. An admin-managed grouping of galaxies that behaves like a galaxy in its own right. Editors do not author clusters; they see them in the picker if they have access. Chapter 12 covers union behaviour generally.

Cosmic theme. The default visual theme for a galaxy: stars, planets, rockets. Other themes: Simple, Abstract, Rectangles, Stripes, Tech. Chapter 4.

Description. The body text of a wormhole, displayed inside the info card. Supports basic markdown. Chapter 5.

Discovery. The section of the galaxy settings modal that toggles visitor-side features: auto-tour, idle spotlight, keyword chips, related wormholes, 2D view. Chapter 4 (modal) and chapter 10 (visitor side).

Dwell time. The number of seconds an auto-tour pauses at each wormhole before moving on. Chapter 11.

Editor. The role assigned to a user who authors content. Distinguished from the operator (who runs the instance). This manual is written for editors.

Editorial sovereignty. The principle that editors decide what goes into a galaxy and how it is tagged, without a review queue or central vocabulary. Chapter 13.

Galaxy. The largest unit an editor works with. A collection of related wormholes plus a framing, a theme, and a set of tags. Chapter 4.

Galaxy tag. A short label (chapter 4) added to a galaxy in its settings modal. Two galaxies with the same tag form a union; visitors at `/tag/<slug>` see both. Chapter 12.

Galaxy union. A view that shows the wormholes of two or more galaxies together while keeping each wormhole in its source galaxy. Reached via galaxy tags, bracket prefix, or an explicit `?galaxies=` URL. Chapter 12.

Icon. The 3D representation of a wormhole in the scene. By default, the galaxy theme's icon; can be overridden per-wormhole (chapter 6).

Idle spotlight. A Discovery feature (chapter 10) that gently highlights a different wormhole every N seconds when the visitor has been idle.

Image attribution. A free-text field next to an uploaded image (chapter 6) for credit or licence notes. Travels with the image into the info card footer.

Info card. The panel that opens over the 3D scene when a visitor clicks a wormhole. Contains the wormhole's name, primary visual, description, audio, keywords, and Open Link button. Chapter 10.

Instance. A single deployment of Telaris at a web address. Your instance is the one whose URL is in your address bar. Multiple instances may federate (cross-instance content is operator territory).

Keyword. A short label attached to wormholes (chapter 7). Two wormholes sharing a keyword are connected. Keywords are case-insensitive and global by text across the instance.

Keyword canvas. The full-viewport drawing surface (chapter 8) where editors lay out keyword chips and draw relationship lines between them. Desktop-only.

Keyword chips. (1) The pastel pills shown inside the editor for keyword editing. (2) The Discovery feature that paints a chip strip at the bottom of the visitor scene; visitors click a chip to dim wormholes that do not carry the keyword. Chapter 10.

Loop. (1) The audio loop toggle: an audio track restarts after it finishes. (2) The tour loop toggle: the auto-tour cycles back to the start after the final wormhole. Chapter 6 and chapter 11.

Manual. (1) This document. (2) An auto-tour start mode where the visitor must press Play. Chapter 11.

Media. The collective name for image, video, audio, PDF, and embed-code attached to a wormhole. Chapter 6.

Multigalaxy. The general name for views that show more than one galaxy at once. Achieved via tags, bracket prefix, or explicit URL list. Chapter 12.

Multigalaxy view. A union of multiple galaxies that visitors can browse as if it were one scene, with each wormhole keeping the visual theme of its source galaxy. Chapter 12.

Object. The default Wormhole type. An Object wormhole carries content (description, media). Contrast with Portal. Chapter 5.

Operator. The role of the person who runs the Telaris instance. Editors do not perform operator tasks (installation, federation, key management). When this manual says "ask your operator," this is who.

PDF. A document media type. Embedded in the visitor's info card with an in-page reader. Chapter 6.

Per-peer keys, Pluriverse, federation. Operator-domain concepts. Not relevant to editors; covered in the Admin Manual.

Portal. A wormhole whose type is Portal: instead of holding content, it points to another galaxy. Visitors who open it travel through. Chapter 9.

Preview tour. A button next to the auto-tour configuration (chapter 11) that opens a visitor view in a new tab with the tour running, so you can check the configuration before saving.

Primary visual. The single image, video, or PDF a wormhole carries. Mutually exclusive (the three tabs share a slot). Audio and embed code are separate. Chapter 6.

Random N. An auto-tour node-selection mode: pick N wormholes at random each session. Chapter 11.

Related wormholes. A Discovery feature: the info card shows up to five wormhole chips that share at least one keyword with the open wormhole; clicking jumps to the related wormhole. Chapter 10.

Slug. The short URL-safe form of a galaxy or wormhole name. Galaxies have a slug visible in the URL bar. Slugs do not change once set.

Snapshot. An operator-side backup of the entire instance. Editors do not take snapshots; the Admin Manual covers them.

Sovereignty. See *Editorial sovereignty*.

Source community. A community whose work is hosted in a Telaris galaxy. The community's consent is the editorial floor; withdrawal of consent is final. Chapter 13.

Tagged keywords. An auto-tour node-selection mode: visit only wormholes carrying one of a chosen set of keywords. Chapter 11.

Theme. The visual style of a galaxy: cosmic, simple, abstract, rectangles, stripes, tech. Chosen in the galaxy settings modal. Chapter 4.

Tour. See *Auto-tour*.

Union. See *Galaxy union*.

Use as wormhole icon. A per-wormhole toggle that renders the wormhole's image as its 3D scene icon, replacing the theme's default. Chapter 6.

View (button). A button next to the galaxy picker that opens the current galaxy in visitor mode, in a new tab. Chapter 4.

Visitor. The reader of a galaxy. A visitor reads the content the editor publishes; they do not see the editor surface. The visitor view is what shows after a click on the View button or a direct URL.

Visitor view. The 3D (or 2D) scene that visitors see. Driven by the editor's choices in the wormhole modal and the galaxy settings modal. Chapter 10.

2D view. An alternative visitor surface (chapter 10) that renders the galaxy as a flat grid of wormhole chips. Toggled by the visitor; the toggle is enabled on the galaxy settings Discovery section.

Wormhole. The smallest unit of content in Telaris. A single passage of text, image, video, PDF, audio, or composite. Chapter 5.

Wormhole type. A field in the wormhole modal: Object (default, carries content) or Portal (carries a destination galaxy). Chapter 5 and chapter 9.